

SUNDAY 16 AUGUST 2026

Twentieth Sunday Ordinary Time

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:

Aghyaran • Ardstraw West & Castlederg • Drumquin

REV PAUL FRASER PP, Tel:028 816 71393; REV THOMAS CANNING CC, Tel: 028 82831 225

SCHEDULE FOR THIS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday 17 August		Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm	Mass, 10.00am Rosary, 8.00pm at Grotto
Tuesday 18 August	Mass, 10.00am		
Wednesday 19 August			Mass, 10.00am
Thursday 20 August	Mass, 10.00am		
Friday 21 August		Mass, Castlederg: 10.00am	
Saturday 22 August	Vigil Mass, 7.30pm: <i>Month's Mind, Danny Gallen</i>	Vigil Mass, Castlederg, 6.15pm	Vigil Mass: 5.00pm
Sunday 23 August	<i>Mass on 1st, 3rd and 5th Sunday</i>	Mass: Dregish, 9.30am Castlederg, 11.00am Drumnabey, 12.30pm	<i>Mass on 1st, 3rd and 5th Sunday</i>

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:

AGHYARAN: £835 & €41. **Church Restoration Fund:** £616 & €37.

ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £2,440 & €48, made up of:

Castlederg £1,641 & €41, **Drumnabey** £417 & €7, **Dregish** £382. **DRUMQUIN:** £464.

Thank you, as always, to all who contribute by Standing Order.

EMBRACE THE GRACE' Legion of Mary Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August, 9.30am – 6.00pm: a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion HQ at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. Tickets cost €20 and can be booked on eventbrite website - look up 'Embrace the Grace'. Any queries can be directed to deusetpatria@gmail.com.

SONGS FROM HOME - Join with local singers to celebrate our cultural roots in Tyrone - learn to sing songs written about Tyrone by people who were born here. Perform them as part of a song and story path in the Ulster American Folk Park, Omagh, on Saturday 11 October, 10.30am – 2.00pm. Rehearsal dates are: Wed 19 Aug, 7.30pm - 9.30pm - Silverbirch Hotel; Sun 30 August, 1.00 - 4.00pm - Dromore Sports Complex; Wed 23 Sept, 7.30pm - 9.30pm - Silverbirch Hotel; Wed 30 Sept, 7.30pm - 10.00pm - Dromore Sports Complex; Wed 7 Oct, 7.30pm - 9.30pm - Silverbirch Hotel. Everyone is welcome, regardless of singing experience. For more information, please contact Claire on 07751 371800 or Fionnuala on 07966 409372.

TEAM HOPE FUNDRAISING GARDEN PARTY – Friday 4 Sept, 2.00 – 7.00pm, 30 Lurganbuoy Road, Castlederg. Live music with Macdara O'Dwyer. Tea, coffee, treats, raffle – supported by local businesses – garden games, fun for children and families. Deborah Lowry wishes you to know that everyone is welcome and you can drop in at any time during the afternoon or evening.

Our prayers are asked for the happy repose of the souls of those recently enrolled in the Derry Diocesan Society:

Aghyaran: Peter Moss, Scraghey Road; Madge McNamee, Meelmore Drive, Omagh.

Drumquin: Paddy Gallagher, Tattysalagh Road; Finola Scott, Meelmore Drive, Omagh.

Ardstraw West and Castlederg: Charlie Logue, Castlefin Park; Christine Clarke, 120 Lenagh Road, Omagh

Ardmore Parish Newsletter

Eighteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Sunday 2nd August 2026

Thoughts on the Gospel

Matthew 14:13–21 – The Feeding of the Five Thousand

The miracle of the loaves and fishes begins with **compassion**. Before Jesus fed the crowd, He first recognised their suffering and their need. His heart was moved by those who were tired, hungry, and searching for hope.

In our own busy lives, God gently calls us to notice those around us who may be lonely, discouraged, forgotten, or struggling. A simple word of encouragement, a listening ear, or a small act of kindness may become someone else's miracle.

The disciples looked only at what they **didn't have**. Faced with thousands of hungry people, they saw only five loaves and two fish. Jesus, however, asked them to offer what they already possessed.

God rarely asks us for what we do not have. Instead, He asks us to place before Him our time, our talents, our compassion, and our willingness to serve. However small these gifts may seem, He is able to multiply them beyond anything we could imagine.

Before distributing the food, Jesus lifted everything to His Father in prayer. This reminds us that surrender is not a sign of weakness or defeat. Rather, it is an act of trust. We all carry burdens that feel too heavy or situations that seem impossible, yet when we place them into God's hands, what appears insufficient can become more than enough.

Finally, the twelve baskets of leftovers remind us of God's overwhelming generosity. His blessings are never intended to stop with us but to flow through us. When we forgive generously, encourage freely, and share what we have with others, God's grace continues to multiply in countless lives.

Prayer

Lord, fill our hearts with compassion. Use the little we have to accomplish great things for Your Kingdom. Teach us to trust You completely, to surrender our limitations into Your hands, and to share Your blessings generously with all whom we meet. Amen.

Readings for Next Sunday

Sunday 9th August 2026

First Reading: 1 Kings 19:9a, 11–13a

Psalm: Psalm 85:9–14

Second Reading: Romans 9:1–5

Gospel: Matthew 14:22–33

Saints of the Coming Week

Tuesday

- St John Vianney, Priest

Wednesday

- The Dedication of the Basilica of St Mary Major (Rome)

Thursday

- The Transfiguration of the Lord

Friday

- St Cajetan, Priest
- St Sixtus II, Pope, and Companions, Martyrs

Saturday

- St Dominic, Priest
-

Pope's Prayer Intention for August

For Evangelisation in the City

Let us pray that in large cities, often marked by anonymity and loneliness, we may discover new ways of proclaiming the Gospel, finding creative paths to build genuine Christian communities.

Prayer for Vocations

We pray for men whom God is calling to the priesthood.

Like Jesus in today's Gospel, may they never turn away from the poor, the hungry, the vulnerable or those most in need, but always reflect the compassionate love of Christ as they nourish His people through the Word of God and the Eucharist.

Parish & Diocesan Notices

Rosary on the Coast

Today (Sunday) at 3.00 pm

 Lisfannon Beach

Praying for **peace, Ireland and our unborn children.**

Everyone is warmly welcome.

Give Blood – Save Lives

The **Northern Ireland Blood Transfusion Service** will hold a blood donor session at:

Lisneal College

70 Crescent Link

Derry BT47 5FQ

Monday 4th August

- 12.30 pm – 4.00 pm
- 5.00 pm – 7.30 pm

 Freephone: **0808 553 4653** to book.

Franciscan Friary, Rossnowlagh

Monthly Healing Service

Today (Sunday)

- Rosary – **2.45 pm**
 - Mass & Healing Service – **3.00 pm**
 - Confessions – **2.00 pm – 5.00 pm**
-

ACCORD Marriage Preparation

Marriage preparation courses are available throughout the year.

Please visit www.accordni.com for dates and booking information.

Monthly Mass for Sr Clare Crockett

Sunday 9th August

7.00 pm

Carmelite Retreat Centre
Termonbacca, Derry

Day of Healing & Prayer

House of Prayer, Clonfert

Saturday 15th August

Led by **Eddie Stone**

A bus will travel from **Letterkenny**, collecting pilgrims in **Ballybofey** and **Donegal Town**.
A priest will accompany the pilgrimage.

 **Contact: 086 393 6547**

Walk in Our Patron Saint's Footsteps

St Patrick's Way Pilgrim Walk

Saturday 8th August

9.00 am – 3.00 pm

Downpatrick

Guides:

- Martina Purdy
- Elaine Kelly

Cost: £55

 **028 4461 9000**

Visit www.saintpatrickcentre.com

Youth & Young Adults

Embrace the Grace

Legion of Mary Young Adult Catholic Conference

(Ages 18–40)

Saturday 29th August

9.30 am – 6.00 pm

De Montfort House
Morning Star Avenue
Dublin D07 VA03

Tickets available through Eventbrite (search **Embrace the Grace**).

Youth 2000 Summer Festival

13th–16th August

Newbridge College, Kildare

Young people aged **16–35** are invited to enjoy:

- Inspiring talks
- Workshops
- Daily Mass
- Music and Prayer
- Fellowship
- Free buses
- All meals included

Visit **youth2000.ie** or follow **@Youth2000Ireland**.

Anam Óg Summer Scheme

3rd–7th August

12.00 pm – 4.00 pm daily

Termonbacca, Derry

For children aged **8–14**

Faith, friendship, games, arts & crafts, adventure and prayer.

Email:

termonbaccaderry@ocd.ie

Community & Charity

Mary's Meals

Annual Step by Step Walk

Sunday 9th August

12.00 noon

Starting from:

Sainsbury's Car Park

Strand Road, Derry

Walking the Foyle Bridge and Peace Bridge.

Everyone is welcome—even if only for part of the walk.

Mary's Meals currently provides a daily school meal to **over 3 million children across 16 countries.**

Please keep all participants in your prayers.

Family Carers Ireland

Remote one-to-one support clinics are available **every Tuesday throughout August.**

Carers can speak privately from the comfort of their own homes.

 086 836 3842

 Donegalcs@familycarers.ie

Pro-Life Events

Donegal Pro Life Church Gate Collection

Saturday 15th & Sunday 16th August

Countywide Collection

Volunteers are greatly appreciated.

 Margaret:
00353 89 246 9599

Míle buíochas.

Monthly Pro-Life Witness

Friday 7th August
1.00 pm – 2.00 pm

Roundabout at Letterkenny University Hospital.

Everyone welcome.

Pilgrimages

Lough Derg Annual Fundraising Draw

Support Station Island and help preserve this special place of pilgrimage for future generations.

Tickets

- Single: **€10**
- Book of 6: **€50**

Those returning a full book will also be entered into the **Early Bird Draw on 28th August 2026.**

Main Draw

23rd October 2026

Prizes

 €10,000

 €5,000

 €2,000

4th – €1,500

5th – €1,000

6th – €500

Lough Derg Day Retreats

As the Three-Day Pilgrimage season concludes (final day to begin is **13th August**), Day Retreats resume on:

- August: **18, 22, 23, 29 & 31**
- September: **5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19 & 20**

Take time away from the busyness of everyday life for guided prayer, quiet reflection and spiritual renewal.

Advance booking is essential.

Employment Opportunity

Administrative & Financial Officer

Clonmany Parish

The **Derry Diocesan Trust** invites applications for the position of:

Administrative & Financial Officer

Hours: 9 per week

Application packs are available from:

Bishop's House
St Eugene's Cathedral
Derry BT48 9AP

 028 7126 2302

 recruitment@derrydiocese.org

Closing Date: Tuesday **11th August 2026**

Publications

Reflections Through Poetry

A beautiful collection by **Fr John P. Forbes**

Available from the **Pastoral Office**

Price: £10

All proceeds support **Children in Crossfire** and the **Cause for the Canonisation of Sr Clare Crockett**.

Sharing the Good News

Read the latest weekly Catholic e-zine featuring news, reflections and resources from across Ireland.

Visit **theway.ie/ezine-2/**.

Closing Prayer

May the Lord bless us with compassionate hearts, generous spirits, and unwavering trust in His providence. May we recognise Christ in those around us, offer Him the little we possess, and witness His abundant blessings multiplying in our families, our parish, and our community.

May Almighty God bless you, the Father, ✠ the Son, and the Holy Spirit. Amen.

Sunday, 5th July 2026 - Ardstraw East Parish Newsletter -

Parish of Ardstraw East

14th Sunday in Ordinary Time

5th July 2026

CONTACTS AND CORRESPONDENCE

Rev. Roland Colhoun, CC, 41 Moyle Road, Newtownstewart, BT78 4AP

Tel: 028-8166 1445, Email: ardstraweast@derrydiocese.org, FB: @ardstraweast

Rev. Brian Donnelly, PP, 028-8164 8283 Rev. James Devine, CC, 028-8230 2012

LITURGIES FOR THE WEEK

Sunday – Mass 11:30am, Rosary 11:10am (Oratory)

Monday – Mass 10am, Rosary 9:45am (Oratory)

Thursday – Holy Hour 6:30pm, Confessions, Rosary, Mass 7.30pm (Oratory)

REQUIESCANT IN PACE – ANNIVERSARIES

John McNamee, Jean Hobbs, Elizabeth McColgan, John-Joe Devine, Maureen Mayse Eileen Orr,

Andrew Bolton, James Bolton, Eileen Duffy, Gerald Devine

SUNDAY COLLECTION – £862. *Glenock Restoration*: £650. Thank you!

FORTY HOURS – Thanks to all who took part in the Adoration, Friday to Sunday. This is our 7th year of 40 full hours. 280 hours offered to God. Graces are flowing!

YOUTH 2000 SUMMER FESTIVAL – 13th–16th August, for youths 16–35. Newbridge College, Co. Kildare. Donation-only, free buses available across the country, all meals included. Inspiring talks and workshops, Mass, music, prayer, and plenty of opportunities to chill out and meet other young Catholics. Whether you are new to the Faith or looking to be refreshed, you are welcome.

To register or find out more, visit youth2000.ie or follow @Youth2000Ireland.

LOUGH DERG – DIOCESE OF DERRY PILGRIMAGE – Friday 24th to Sunday 26th July. Three days of prayer, peace, reflection and renewal. Cost: £95 including bus transport. Booking form and full details are

available at derrydiocese.org/lough-derg

ADDICTION – MATT TALBOT PRAYER SOCIETY, MONTHLY MASS, in St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, tomorrow, Monday 6th July, 7.30pm. The Mass is offered for all those dealing with addiction and their families. Everyone is welcome to attend. Free Spiritual Protection Packs for the protection of families and homes from drugs.

PREPARATION FOR HEAVEN – 'No one will be fit to receive the life to come unless he has prepared himself in this life to receive it.' (Saint Augustine of Hippo).

LAST BULLETIN OF THE SEASON – Please note that there will be no printed bulletin for July and August. Kindly continue to send anniversary notices to the parish office, to be read out at Mass. Keep up to date on our Facebook page. Thank you for your faith, hope and love and immense support throughout the year. Blessings to you!

JOKE – Where do birds go on holidays? Somewhere cheep!

JOKE – What do you call a greedy crab? Shellfish!



St Mary's Bellaghy/St Joseph's Ballyscullion.
16 August 2026
Twentieth Sunday in Ordinary Time.



Mass Times :

St Mary's, Bellaghy

Mon 17, No Mass **Wed 19**, 9.30am
Adoration, Friday, 10am—8pm (Rosary, 7.30pm)
Sat, 5.30pm (Streamed from Greenlough)
Sun, 11am (Streamed to Greenlough)

St. Oliver Plunkett, Clady:

Tues 18 & Fri 21, 9.30am
Adoration, Thursday, 9am—5pm.
Sat, Vigil, 5.30pm (Streamed to Bellaghy)
Sun, 11am (Streamed from Bellaghy)

St. Joseph's, Ballyscullion:

Sun, 9.45am.

**The Offertory
Collection**

last Sunday
amounted to
£1,846.00 **Thank You!**



That the men called to priesthood will
 "...have a care for justice [and] act
 with integrity..." as they preach the
 message of God's salvation for
 everyone, the Good News that the
 Church is "...a house of prayer for all
 the peoples."



*There will be a bulletin next weekend
 22/23 August.*

*Please have all notices and anniversaries in to the
 Parish Office by Wednesday 19 August at 11am.*

**Church Island Sunday will take
 place this year on
 Sunday 30 August at 2pm.**

Deaths: We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of **Bridget Murphy (Mullaghboy Road)**
 who died recently.

ANNIVERSARIES

Sat/Sun 15/16: Fr. Jim Smith, Tony Convery, Eva Agnew, Catherine Scullion, Pearse
 McMullan, Brigid McErlean, Brigid McLaughlin, Harry Campbell, Tony, Robert & Bridget
 Smith, Felix Gribbon.

Sat/Sun 22/23: Rosaleen Cudden (Anniversary Mass at 11am),
 Sean Diamond (Anniversary Mass Fri 28 Aug at 7pm), James Diamond, PJ Mulholland,
 Frank Ferran, Hugh Devlin, Maureen Friel, Susan O'Neill, Annie Shivers, Tommy Scullion,
 Colm McCartney, Sean Farmer. ***May they rest in peace.***

BAPTISM DATES: JULY—DECEMBER

BELLAGHY

Sep 26, 1pm
Oct 10, 1pm
Nov 7, 1pm
Dec 5, 1pm

GREENLOUGH

Aug 22 4.15pm
Sep 13, 12.30pm
Oct 24, 4.15pm
Nov 21, 4.15pm
Dec 19, 4.15pm

Buncrana Parish Newsletter

ST. MARY'S HALL & CINEMA

Last week’s collection totalled €5,315 <i>Sincere thanks.</i>		Fr Bradley 9363455 Fr Walsh 9361393 Fr Baker 9360151 Parish Office 9361253 Parish Catechist 086 785 3726		PARISH DRAW Friday 7 August: Week 8 1st Prize: €500 Shaneen Doherty, Upper Gransha <i>Promoter: Sean Doherty (Clarke)</i> 2nd Prize: €300 Rose Porter, Cockhill Park <i>Promoter: Helen Doherty</i> 3rd Prize: €150 Jim Mulhern, Drumfries <i>Promoter: Noeleen Tynan</i>		BUNCRANA CINEMA See all show times www.thecinemabuncrana.com			BINGO						
Anniversary Masses & Times		Email: buncranaparish@gmail.com Website: www.buncranaparish.com Twentieth Sunday in Ordinary Time 16th August 2026		ADORATION CHAPEL Please consider spending an hour in the Adoration Chapel Sunday 2pm - 10pm Monday - Wednesday 6am - 10pm Friday 6am - 10pm		Practical Magic (1998) Sat 15th & Sun 16th August 8.15pm		Spider-Man: Brand New Day 12A 145mins Sat 15th - 5pm Sun 16th - 3pm		The Odyssey 15A 175mins Mon 17th - Wed 19th 8.15pm Thurs 20th - 1pm		COMING SOON Movies & Tea Holy Days - Tues 1st Sept. Adm €10 incl Afternoon Tea. Carers go free.		St Mary’s Hall Fridays at 8pm Single book €11 Double €17 Snowball: €495	
ST MARY’S ORATORY Masses streamed on churchservices.tv/buncrana Monday 17 Aug - Mass at 10am Ignatius Boyle Tuesday 18 Aug - Mass at 10am Wednesday 19 Aug - Mass at 10am Mamie Porter Thursday 20 Aug - Mass at 10am Sarah Barr (MM) Saturday 22 Aug - Mass at 4:30pm Sundav 23 Aug - Mass at 8:30am Sunday 23 Aug - Mass at 12:30pm Matilda (Tilly) Forshaw (10th A) and Dorothy Prendergast (5th A)		GARDEN FETE 2026 The Annual Garden Fete will take place next Sunday 23 August from 3pm-6pm in the grounds of Scoil Mhuire. This event can only take place because of the generosity of a team of volunteers. Please leave your details in the Parish Office if you can help out on or before the day. DRAW CARDS Draw cards for hampers and other great prizes are available from the Parish Office and promoters are required. Please contact the office to get your card or to buy a line. CALLING OUT TO ALL BAKERS & CRAFTERS Bakers required to provided goods for the tea/coffee. Please leave any goods in the Convent kitchen any-time from 11am onwards on the day. Book your table for the Garden Fete to display and sell your crafts, €20 per table. Limited tables available. For more details contact the Parish Office 074-9361253.		GUIDED HOLY HOUR The Holy Hour in honour of the Holy Face of Jesus continues this Sunday at 6pm in St Mary’s Oratory. All Welcome.		EMBRACE THE GRACE YOUNG ADULT CATHOLIC CONFERENCE 29 Aug 2026 - Legion of Mary: 'Embrace the Grace' is a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. This event is on Sat 30 August from 9.30am to 6pm with a social after. Tickets €20 and can be booked on the eventbrite website by looking up 'Embrace the Grace'. Any queries email deusetpatria@gmail.com . ANAM CARA is very pleased to announce our first Bereavement Information Evening especially dedicated to supporting surviving siblings this autumn. As part of our commitment to supporting everyone following the death of a child, we are exploring opportunities to further support the entire family. This event is the first, hopefully of many, of that commitment. This event is open to all parents whose child or children have died, regardless of the age of their child, circumstances of their death, or time since bereavement. We are also opening this Bereavement Information Evening to bereaved adult siblings over 18. This event will take place online on Tues 15 Sept at 7pm. Bereaved parents and adult be-reaved siblings are invited to register at info@anamcara.ie or call 085 288 8888. BUNCRANA PANTOMIME SOCIETY It’s that time of year again! The Buncrana Pantomime Society is holding a casting meeting for this year’s production of “Robinson Crusoe” on Wed 19th Aug at 8pm in St Mary’s Hall, Buncrana, Open to anyone from 13 and over. Sign up on the night to Audition for all parts. No experience necessary! Everyone is welcome to take part - whether on stage or behind the scenes. This is a great way to make new friendships, have fun, and a great way to spend the winter nights. We are all voluntary and proceeds from the show go back into the community. Put the date in your diary come along and enjoy. Looking forward to seeing you all there AVANT GARDEN STUDIO Children's Summer Art Workshops coming up in a double bill of making on Friday 21 August at Buncrana Angler's Centre. Clay workshop 11.30am- 1.30pm. Painting workshop 2.30pm - 4.30pm. Age 7+. Limited spaces. Contact Geraldine 086 377 2399		Community Corner		SLIABH SNEACHT CENTRE Drumfries Walking Group will be meeting on Fri 21 Aug at Ned’s Point carpark, at 10am everyone welcome. Weekly drop in Craft Class starts back on Wed 9 Sept (Sewing /Embroidery/ Knitting) no tutor, just a group of like minded people supporting each other while enjoying a cup of tea and a chat, bring your own materials and sewing machine. €3 per class, contact the centre on 0749361742 for more info. THE CHILD BEHAVIOUR CONSULTANCY Roisín Doherty - Behaviour Analyst consults with parents of children 3-12 years of age (with or without a diagnosis) to help their child accept ‘no’, listen, regulate their big emotions etc. Contact 0894511432 to get a consultation set up. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS Amazing Grace Group, Buncrana have 5 meetings per week as follows: Sun 8pm, Tues 8pm, Thurs 11.30am, Fri 8pm & Sat 11.30am. If you think you may have a problem with alcohol, come along. Meeting in St Teresa’s Room. AL-ANON GROUP (for anyone whose life is or has been affected by someone else’s drinking) meet in St Teresa’s Room on Thurs at 6:45pm. GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS weekly meeting in St Teresa’s Room each Sun 5pm-6.30pm for anyone struggling with a gambling addiction. GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS HELPLINE Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 048 7135 1329. THE PLAZA Social Dances: Sat 15 August Fanadian; Sat 22 August Michael Cleary and Jackie Bannon; Sat 29 August Trevor Loughery. Doors 9pm, Dancing 9:30pm. Admission €10. Hall available for hire & for children’s birthday parties. Contact Ursula on 0877538317 INISHOWEN MEDICAL Hearing loss? Earache? Blocked ears? It could just be wax. Inishowen Medical can help with that. We can offer both our patients and non-patients microsuction. Microsuction is a newer and more patient friendly way of clearing wax from ears. It is considered comfortable for the patient and can be used in every ear, even if there is a history of perforations. Get your hearing back today by calling Inishowen Medical to make an appointment on 074 93 61800 or 074 76173. DANCE FITNESS CLASS Every Tues 7-8pm in St Mary’s Hall, Buncrana. All welcome to this full body workout to music. PIANO LESSONS Beginner piano lessons available in the Buncrana area, contact Lauren on 0864558483 for more details. LIFELINE INISHOWEN Domestic Violence Support Services have free counselling sessions available for Women & Children, We also offer support, drop-in and outreach services. Contact us on our HELPLINE 074 9373232 or 086 0065035330 between 10am - 1.30pm SAMARITANS Call Free 116 123 , Text 087 2609090 . NOWDOC Phone Number: 0818400911 RACHEL’S VINEYARD Have you been affected or hurt by abortion? Please contact Michelle on 00447871765181		SLIMMING WORLD Buncrana: The Exchange every Tues 8am, 9.30am & 11am with Ann Marie 0860848705, 6pm with Marie 0877389059. Carndonagh: The Colgan Hall every Thurs at 6pm with Marie 0877389059. Newtowncunningham: The Orange Hall every Wed at 6.30pm with Ann Marie 0860848705. GET THE GRADE English Tuition. Friendly, exam-focused, Junior & Leaving Cert tuition with experienced teacher of English & SEC Examiner (Teaching Council and Garda vetted). Text/Call Mark 0866655334 INISHOWEN INJURY CLINIC Treatment of back, neck and shoulder pain / sports injuries / rehabilitation. Contact Cahir McLaughlin NMT, Maginn Ave 0860753296 HEALTH & WELLBEING PARK RUN Come and join our community of walkers, runners and volunteers every Sat at 9.15am by the shore front play park. All welcome GENTLE EXERCISE CLASS for people living with Parkinson's every Wed at 2pm in The Exchange. COCKHILL CEILI CLUB Classes have now stopped for the summer months. CEILI in Cockhill School Hall Fri 4 Sept. Musi by Martin. Dancing from 8pm-11pm. Adm €10 incl Supper and Raffle tickets. All welcome GAELSCOIL BHUN CRANNCHA Give us a call on 074 9361988 or an email at gsbc1999@gmail.com to discuss how an Irish medium education can benefit your child. If you don’t speak Irish, don’t worry. That won’t hold your child back. COMMUNITY EMPLOYMENT PROGRAMME VACANCIES for a grounds worker for the grave-yard at St Mary’s Cockhill. Contact buncrana@swillycep.ie for more info or application. DOG FREE ZONE A reminder that dogs are not permitted in Cockhill or Desertegney grave-yards. Thank you. SCOIL TRAD BHUN CRANNCHA (School of Irish Traditional Music). Lessons for children (7+); Tin Whistle, Bodhrán, Accordion, Banjo, Mandolin, Fiddle. Registration on Wed 2 Sept 6 -7pm, Buncrana Youth Club, Castle Ave. Contact: Jim Woods on 087 4186082 (Classes start back 9 Sept) SPORTS DAY at Cockhill Celtic Youth & Football Club. Sun 16th Aug 3pm - 6pm. Adults €5 entry fee - U16s free GENTLE HATHA YOGA CLASS beginning on 7 Sept at 7pm in Angler’s Centre. Contact Anne Nelson 086 2586864 for further information. A FEAST OF FOLK MUSIC in The Cairn, Green-castle every Tues at 8pm in July and August. Limited Seating Tel 0749381104.			
ST. MARY’S, COCKHILL Masses streamed on churchservices.tv/cockhill Friday 21 Aug - Mass at 7pm Sunday 23 Aug - Mass at 11am		READINGS FOR 20TH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME First Reading: Is 56:1, 6-7. This passage from Isaiah serves to introduce today’s much-loved gospel passage. The time of writing was probably after 500 BC. The Lord will welcome those Gentiles who come to ‘observe and who cling to my (Mosaic) Covenant.’ God’s house will become for all people a house of heartfelt prayer. Second Reading: Rom. 11:13-15, 29-32. It had been the definitive rejection of Christ by the Jews that had driven the Apostles out of Jerusalem to bring salvation to the Gentiles, i.e., people like the Romans and the Greeks. Yet Paul continues to long that God’s mercy may somehow triumph in achieving the conversion of his countrymen. Their choice by God as the Chosen People was permanent and will never be revoked. Gospel: Mt. 15:21-28. Leaving the argumentative Pharisees and scribes behind, Jesus had moved to southern Lebanon. There he encounters a pagan woman who addresses him with an ardent plea. His initially harsh attitude towards her alters mid-stream. He uses the incident to show his disciples how the Lord will always listen to the pleas, made in humble faith, even of pagans		ROSARY The Rosary is said in the Oratory at 9.30am before Mass Monday to Thursday.		The National Novena to Our Lady of Knock takes place at Knock Shrine from Thurs 13 to Fri 21 August 2026. Novena ceremonies will be celebrated daily at 3pm and 8pm, with workshops and guided prayer sessions also taking place throughout the nine days. This year’s theme is “ Sheltered in God’s Love. ” See the full programme at: https://www.knockshrine.ie/national-novena-2026 -guest-speakers-and-programme/		STAR OF THE SEA, DESERTEGNEY Masses streamed on www.youtube.com/@BuncranaParish Sunday 23 Aug - Mass at 9:45am		BAPTISMS We welcome into God’s Family the following children who were recently baptised: Frankie Doherty Isla Annette Duffy-Blanchard Lily May McGonagle Arlo James O’Donnell Rían Anthony O’Donnell Luca Patrick Moran Sonny Ó Griallais <i>May God guide and protect our children always.</i>		DEATHS Your prayers are asked for Diane Doherty Hugh McLaughlin (Turner) who were buried recently and for their families & friends saddened by their loss.			
PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS That the men called to priesthood will "...have a care for justice [and] act with integrity..." as they preach the message of God's salvation for everyone, the Good News that the Church is "...a house of prayer for all the peoples."		JOB OPPORTUNITY (1) Waterside Parish: Administrative & Financial Officer (18 hours per week), Parochial House, 32 Chapel Road, Derry. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hr - £13.50 per hr. Completed applications to be returned no later than 12noon Mon 24 August 2026 For an application pack please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or tel 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop’s House, St Eugene’s Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org		DONEGAL DOWN SYNDROME ASSOCIATION Annual church-gate collection will take place on the weekend of 29 /30 Aug. Any-one interested in helping on the day can contact the Donegal Down Syndrome Association office by email at info@donegal.downsyndrome.ie or call 0857870075. Your financial support for this important fundraising event would be greatly appreciated and will help in continuing to provide vital services and supports to children and adults with Down Syndrome and their families across Donegal.		CLIMB TO THE EUCHARISTIC CROSS, SCALP on Sunday 30 August meeting at the Water Tank at 1.30pm. The Rosary will be said on the way up. All Welcome.		ST JOSEPH MEN'S CAMINO <i>Every Camino changes us in ways we don't expect, every man needs one.</i> Join men from across Ireland on Sat 12th Sept for a 25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda. The day includes Mass, Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch and dinner, with after-dinner speaker Fr. Mark Quinn . Open to men aged 18+. Cost: €65 (student € 55). Registration, accommodation and details: www.dominicans.ie/events Enquiries: op.evangelisation@gmail.com .		LEGION OF MARY Pilgrimage to Knock on Sunday 27 September leaving from Buncrana. More details to follow.					
PRIVACY NOTICE: The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A Privacy Notice is available on the Parish Website or by contacting The Parish Office. Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in St Mary’s Oratory and St Mary’s Cockhill are available online. Parishioners should note that the first two rows of seats are visible online in St Mary’s Oratory and the first seven rows of seats are visible in St Mary’s Cockhill.		Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.		SAFEGUARDING NOTICE: If you have any concerns with regards to Safeguarding Children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie O’Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) at 0044 7596500793, or at dlp@derrydiocese.org or Garda Síochána , Buncrana 074 9320540, Letterkenny HQ 074 9167100 or TUSLA Family & Child Agency 00353 749102233 ROI Vetting Office: 074 93 63108											

**Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick
Eighteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A – 2nd August 2026**

Parish Clergy

Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215

Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)

Email: leckpatrickparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.leckpatrickparish.com

Email: strabaneparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.camusparish.com

Email: clonleighparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.clonleighparish.com

Thoughts on the Gospel (Matthew 14:13-21)

The miracle of the loaves and fishes began with **compassion**. Jesus first noticed the crowd's pain before providing for their hunger. In our busy lives, God invites us to see those who are lonely, discouraged, or forgotten. Even small acts of kindness can become someone's miracle.

The disciples focused on what they lacked, yet Jesus asked them to offer what they *did* have. God rarely asks for what we do not possess. When we offer our time, talents, and resources — however small — He multiplies them in ways we cannot imagine.

Before the food was shared, Jesus surrendered everything to the Father. We too carry burdens that feel heavy, but surrender is not giving up; it is trusting God with our limitations. What seems insufficient to us becomes more than enough in His hands. The abundance left over reminds us that God's blessings are meant to flow *through* us. When we share generously, encourage others, and forgive freely, His grace continues to multiply.

***Lord, fill us with compassion, use what little we offer, and multiply it for Your glory.
Teach us to trust You and to share Your blessings generously. Amen.***

Monthly Mass in Honour of St Pio will be celebrated on Wednesday 5th August at 7.00 pm in Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane. We ask God's blessing on all through the intercession of St Pio. Everyone welcome.

Due to the Current Holiday Period, we wish to notify parishioners that there will be no newsletter until 22nd/23rd August. Apologies for any inconvenience. The office will be open as follows for the following two weeks: 10 am - 2 pm, Monday - Friday. Normal hours will resume on Monday 17th August.

The Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary

Saturday 15th August is the Feast of the Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary and is a holy day of obligation. On this feast, we recall Mary's role in the life of Jesus and in salvation. Mass times for the holy day are as follows:

Vigil Mass on Friday 14th August at 6.30 pm in Immaculate Conception Church

Mass on Saturday 15th August at 8.30 am in Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

Mass on Saturday 15th August at 10.00 am in St Patrick's Church, Murlog.

Masses at the usual times on the evening of Saturday 15th & Sunday 16th August.

Prayer at Time of Exam Results

Dear Lord, in this moment of uncertainty, I seek Your peace and guidance.
Help me to accept the results of my efforts with grace, whether they meet my hopes or not. Grant me the strength to learn and grow from this experience, trusting in Your plan for my life. May I find comfort in Your love and wisdom.
May Your peace fill my heart as I walk forward in faith. Amen.

Requiescant in Pace We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of Harry Mullen, Victoria Rd, Strabane; Bernie Greene, Tipperary.

Anniversaries Tony Boggs, Joseph Colhoun, Willie Curran, May Doherty, Johnny Forbes, Charlie Gallagher, Johnny Gallagher, Kevin Gallagher, Mary Gallagher, Nellie Gallagher, David Kennedy, Susan Lafferty, Anne Maguire, Bernard McDermott, Laurence McDermott, Emmett McGhee, Thomas McGranaghan, James O'Neill, Martin Stevenson, Vincent Sweeney, James McDermott (60th anniversary), Margaret McCay, Anna Morgan. May they rest in peace.

9.45am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Thank You for your generosity to last week's collections:

Leckpatrick: £1,372.61;

Clonleigh: €1,925.66;

Camus: £1,420.06.

Thanks to those who pay by standing order.

Readings for Sunday 9th August:

1st Reading: First Kings 19: 9a, 11-13a

Psalm: 85: 9, 10, 11-12, 13-14

2nd Reading: Romans 9: 1-5

Gospel: Matthew 14: 22-33

Readings 15th August (Feast of the Assumption):

1st Reading: Revelation 11: 19a; 12: 1-6a, 10ab

Psalm: 45:10,11,12,16

2nd Reading: 1st Corinthians 15:20-27;

Gospel: Luke 1:39-56

Readings for Sunday 16th August:

1st Reading: Isaiah 56: 1, 6-7

Psalm: 67: 2-3, 5, 6, 8

2nd Reading: Romans 11: 13-15, 29-32

Gospel: Matthew 15: 21-28

Readings for Sunday 23rd August:

1st Reading: Isaiah 22:19-23

Psalm: 137:1-3, 6, 8

2nd Reading: Romans 11:33-36

Gospel: Matthew 16:13-20

Saints of The Coming Week:

Tuesday: St John Vianney, priest;

Wed: The Dedication of the Basilica of St Mary Major in Rome;

Thurs: The Transfiguration of the Lord;

Fri: St Cajetan, priest; St Sixtus II, pope, & companions, martyrs;

Sat: St Dominic, priest

Embrace the Grace Legion of Mary Young Adult (18-40) Catholic Conference takes place on Sat 29th August from 9.30 am - 6 pm at De Montfort House, Morning Star Ave, Dublin, D07 VA03. Tickets from www.eventbrite. Search Embrace the Grace.

Pope's Prayer Intention for August *For evangelisation in the city*

Let us pray that in large cities often marked by anonymity and loneliness we find new ways to proclaim the Gospel, discovering creative paths to build community.

Rosary on the Coast takes place today (Sunday) at 3.00 pm at Lisfannon Beach, praying for peace, Ireland and our unborn children. Everyone welcome.

Give Blood, Save Lives NI Blood Transfusion Service will collect blood donations at Lisneal College, 70 Crescent Link, Derry, BT47 5FQ on 4th August from 1230 pm - 4.00 pm & 5.00 pm - 7.30 pm. Please freecall 08085534653 to book.

Lough Derg Annual Fundraising Draw to ensure Station Island remains open for future generations. Single ticket: €10. Book of 6: €50. Buy a full book and you're entered into a sellers' draw. Return a complete book for Early Bird draws on 28/8/26. Tickets from www.loughderg.org/store/c3/annualdraw or +353 (0) 719861518 or info@loughderg.org Prizes: 1st: €10,000, 2nd: €5,000, 3rd: €2,000, 4th: €1,500, 5th: €1,000, 6th: €500. Draw date: 23rd October 2026.

Job Opportunity Derry Diocesan Trust invites applications for the post of Administrative & Financial Officer at Clonmany Parish. 9 hours pw. For application pack, please contact Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, BT48 9AP, 02871262302 or recruitment@derrydiocese.org Closing date: 11th August 2026.

Franciscan Friary, Rossnowlagh Monthly Healing Service today (Sunday). Rosary at 2.45 pm followed by Mass / Healing Service at 3 pm. Confessions 2 - 5 pm.

ACCORD Derry Marriage Preparation Courses available at www.accordni.com

Monthly Mass in Memory of Sr Clare Crockett will be celebrated on Sunday 9th August at 7 pm in Carmelite Retreat Centre, Termonbacca, Derry.

Pray for Vocations We pray for men called to priesthood. Like Jesus in today's gospel, may they never turn away from the poor, hungry, most vulnerable or those in need, but always reflect the love of Christ as they nourish and strengthen them with the Word of God. Visit <https://derryvocations.org>

A Day of Healing & Prayer in the House of Prayer, Clonfert with Eddie Stone on Sat 15th August. A bus leaves Letterkenny, collecting people in Ballybofey and Donegal Town. A priest will accompany the group. Please contact 0863936547.

Sharing the Good News Visit <https://theway.ie/ezine-2/> for the weekly ezine.

Sean Davis 4 Day Outdoor Summer Fun Soccer Academy takes place at Templemore Sports Complex, Derry from 4th - 7th August. Boys and girls aged 5 - 18 welcome. Times: 10 am - 3 pm. Please contact Sean on 07787791880.

Youth 2000 Festival | 13th–16th August Calling all young people (16 - 35). Join us in Newbridge College, Kildare. Free buses. All meals included. Inspiring talks, workshops, Mass, music, prayer, and plenty of opportunities to chill out and meet other young Catholics. Visit youth2000.ie or follow @Youth2000Ireland

Family Carers Ireland are running 1:1 support clinics remotely every Tuesday in August for carers, offering you a space and time to talk over the phone in the comfort of your own home. Contact 0868363842 or Donegalcs@familycarers.ie

Lough Derg As the **3 Day Pilgrimage** season draws to a close soon (final day to start is 13th August), our **Day Retreats** recommence on August 18, 22, 23, 29 & 31 and September 5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19, 20. Take time away from the busyness of life for a day of guided prayer, quiet reflection and spiritual renewal in the peaceful surroundings of Lough Derg. Booking essential. Please visit www.loughderg.org

Mary's Meals Annual Step by Step Walk takes place on Sunday 9th August at 12 noon from Sainsbury's car park, Strand Rd, Derry, walking around the Foyle Bridge & Peace Bridge. All welcome, even for a mile or two. Mary's Meals currently feeds over 3 million children a daily school meal across 16 countries. For further details / to register, please visit www.marysmeals.org.uk/step or contact Caoimhe on 07394564065. Please keep all our walkers in your prayers.

Donegal Pro Life Annual Church Gate Collection takes place on Saturday 15th / Sunday 16th August countywide. If you can help in taking up a collection, it would be appreciated. Please contact Margaret on 00353892469599. Míle buíochas.

The Monthly Pro Life Witness / Gathering takes place at the roundabout at Letterkenny Hospital on Friday 7th August from 1 pm - 2 pm. All welcome.

The Contemplative Prayer Group meets on Mondays at 8 pm in the Prayer Room in the Parochial House, Barrack St. All welcome.

Termonbacca Derry Anam Óg Summer Scheme for those aged 8 - 14 takes place from 3rd - 7th August from 12 - 4 pm daily. Faith, friendship, arts and crafts, adventures, games and prayer. Please email termonbaccaderry@ocd.ie

Walk in Our Patron Saint's Footsteps St Patrick's Way Pilgrim Walk, Downpatrick with guides Martina Purdy & Elaine Kelly on **8th August 9 am - 3 pm** Cost (£55). Tel 028 44619000. Visit www.saintpatrickcentre.com

Reflections Through Poetry book by Fr John P Forbes available in Pastoral Office. Cost: £10. Proceeds to Children in Crossfire and Cause for Sr Clare's Canonisation.

Parish Bingo & Lucky Four A warm welcome to all to St Pat's Hall every Thursday at 8 pm. Come along for some fun, excitement and slight competition.

Strabane / Leckpatrick Draw July 2026

Prize	Winner	Promoter
£2,000	Philomena & Bosco Gallagher	Siobhan McDevitt
£1,000	Pat Gallagher	Sadie Kerlin
£500	Fr Paul Farren	Fr Michael
£500	Conal Doherty	Colette McKane
£250	Paddy Quinn	Fr Michael
£250	Brian Devine	Gabrielle Dooher
£100	Finola Kerr	Nuala Kerr
£100	Laura Burke	Paul Mullen
£100	Steven Casey	Paul Mullen
£100	Mary Barrett	Patsy Barrett
£100	Sarah McMichael	Ann McCrory

Congratulations to all the winners. Thank you for your support.

Weekend Mass Schedule

Immaculate Conception: Saturday Vigil: **4.30 pm**; Sunday: **11.00 am**

Sacred Heart, Derry Road: Sunday: **12.15 pm**

St Patrick's, Clonleigh: Saturday Vigil: **6.30 pm**; Sunday: **9.45 am**

St Joseph's, Glenmornan: Sunday: **8.30 am** (2nd August - alternate Sundays - 16th August)

St Mary's, Cloughcor: Sunday: **8.30 am** (9th August - alternate Sundays - 23rd August)

Weekday Mass Schedule

Monday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Tuesday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Wednesday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

(followed by **Eucharistic Adoration** until 5.30 pm).

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Thursday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Friday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Weddings Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months' notice required.

Baptisms: Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

The Parish Pastoral Area Office, 27 Butcher St, Strabane covers all 3 parishes.

Office hours: Monday – Thursday: 9.30 am - 4.30 pm; Friday: 9.30 am - 12.30 pm.

Please feel free to call in or phone on 028 7188 2215.

Reminder that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays.

A Small Collection of Candles is available for purchase at the Pastoral Office.

A gentle reminder that we can only accept cash or cheque payments. Thank you.

Safeguarding (Northern Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Adult at risk of harm or Adult in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact PSNI on 101, Western HSCT Children's Gateway Services on 028 71 314090, WHSCT Adult Gateway Services on 028 71 611366 or the Regional Emergency Social Work Service on 028 95 049999.

Safeguarding (Republic of Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +44 7596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact Garda Síochána Buncrana on 074 93 20540, Garda Síochána Letterkenny on 074 91 67100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency on 074 91 02233 or HSC Adult Safeguarding, Donegal on 071 983 4660.



Sacred Heart Church

Carndonagh

15th & 16th August 2026 (20th Sunday Ordinary Time)

Mass Times

Friday	7.00 pm
Saturday Vigil	7.00 pm
Sunday	9.00 am & 11 am

Baptism

Saturday	6.00 pm
Sunday	12.00 noon

Rosary

Sunday	6.30pm
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Deaths: We wish to express our deepest sympathy to the family and friends of Jim Reid, Drimdoo, his funeral Mass took place on Thursday.

Anniversary and Month's Mind Masses

Sat 15 th Aug	Kathleen Hirrell, Tul na Ri (1 st Anniv) 7pm
Sun 16 th Aug	Coleman Doherty (Olly), Ard Colgan (3 rd Anniv) 9am
Fri 21 st Aug	Barney McCloskey, Glentogher (Month's Mind) 7pm
Sat 22 nd Aug	Anthony Paradiso (Internment of Ashes) 11am
Sat 22 nd Aug	Joseph Callaghan, The Buildings, (Month's Mind) 7 pm
Sun 23 rd Aug	Mary Jo Lafferty, Malin Rd 9am
Sat 29 th Aug	Mary Browne, Hollymount (Month's Mind) 7pm
Sun 30 th Aug	John Collins, Gortin (30 th Anniv) 9am

Anniversaries at this time

Ellen McKinney, Mullins. Margaret Monaghan, Tul na Rí & Marion Doherty, Ard Colgan.

SACRED HEART CHURCH – PARISH DRAW WINNERS

€1000 Anne McLaughlin, Churchtown (Noel Doherty)

€100 John McMenamin (Laura & Emma Doherty)

€50 Charlie & Leeanne Doherty (Bronagh Doherty)

Weekly Collection amounted to € 2372.56 & Stg £ 78.33

Thank you for your generosity.

Vocations: That the men called to priesthood will "...have a care for justice [and] act with integrity..." as they preach the message of God's salvation for everyone, the Good News that the Church is "...a house of prayer for all the peoples."

DONEGAL DOWN SYNDROME ASSOCIATION Annual church-gate collection will take place on the weekend of 29 /30 August. Anyone interested in helping on the day can contact the Donegal Down Syndrome Association office by email at info@donegal.downsyndrome.ie or telephone on 085 787 0075. Your financial support for this important fundraising event would be greatly appreciated and will help in continuing to provide vital services and supports to children and adults with Down syndrome and their families across Donegal.

Anam Cara is very pleased to announce our first Bereavement Information Evening especially dedicated to supporting surviving siblings this autumn. As part of our commitment to supporting everyone following the death of a child, we are exploring opportunities to further support the entire family. This event is the first of that commitment. This event is open to all parents whose child or children have died and we are also opening this Bereavement Information Evening to bereaved adult siblings over 18. **Tuesday 15 September at 7pm.** register here:

<https://us02web.zoom.us/meeting/register/of6tRhtRju5bzN9fQuIVQ#/registration>

MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND: Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential Weekend from Friday 2 to Sunday 4 October 2026 at the Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare. Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage. Visit www.marriageencounter.ie

'Embrace the Grace' Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August 2026
- Legion of Mary: 'Embrace the Grace' is a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. It will be a chance to build faith in friendship with young adults from across the country. This event takes place on Saturday 30 August from 9.30am to 6.00pm with a social afterwards. Tickets cost €20 and can be booked on the eventbrite website by looking up 'Embrace the Grace'. Any queries can be directed towards deusetpatria@gmail.com.

Masses and Baptisms: If you wish to book Masses or Baptisms please call into the Sacristy before or after any Masses or telephone **0860577273**. Parish Office, Macartan's, Carndonagh, Co. Donegal. Tel:(074)9374104 Email:sacredheartchurchcam@gmail.com

SUNDAY 16 AUGUST 2026

Twentieth Sunday Ordinary Time

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:
Aghyaran • Ardstraw West & Castlederg • Drumquin

REV PAUL FRASER PP, Tel:028 816 71393; REV THOMAS CANNING CC, Tel: 028 82831 225

SCHEDULE FOR THIS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday 17 August		Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm	Mass, 10.00am Rosary, 8.00pm at Grotto
Tuesday 18 August	Mass, 10.00am		
Wednesday 19 August			Mass, 10.00am
Thursday 20 August	Mass, 10.00am		
Friday 21 August		Mass, Castlederg: 10.00am	
Saturday 22 August	Vigil Mass, 7.30pm: <i>Month's Mind, Danny Gallen</i>	Vigil Mass, Castlederg, 6.15pm	Vigil Mass: 5.00pm
Sunday 23 August	Mass on <i>1st, 3rd and 5th Sunday</i>	Mass: Dregish, 9.30am Castlederg, 11.00am Drumnabey, 12.30pm	Mass on <i>1st, 3rd and 5th Sunday</i>

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:

AGHYARAN: £835 & €41. **Church Restoration Fund:** £616 & €37.

ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £2,440 & €48, made up of:

Castlederg £1,641 & €41, **Drumnabey** £417 & €7, **Dregish** £382. **DRUMQUIN:** £464.

Thank you, as always, to all who contribute by Standing Order.

EMBRACE THE GRACE' Legion of Mary Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August, 9.30am – 6.00pm: a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion HQ at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. Tickets cost €20 and can be booked on eventbrite website - look up 'Embrace the Grace'. Any queries can be directed to deusetpatria@gmail.com.

SONGS FROM HOME - Join with local singers to celebrate our cultural roots in Tyrone - learn to sing songs written about Tyrone by people who were born here. Perform them as part of a song and story path in the Ulster American Folk Park, Omagh, on Saturday 11 October, 10.30am – 2.00pm. Rehearsal dates are: Wed 19 Aug, 7.30pm - 9.30pm - Silverbirch Hotel; Sun 30 August, 1.00 - 4.00pm - Dromore Sports Complex; Wed 23 Sept, 7.30pm - 9.30pm - Silverbirch Hotel; Wed 30 Sept, 7.30pm - 10.00pm - Dromore Sports Complex; Wed 7 Oct, 7.30pm - 9.30pm - Silverbirch Hotel. Everyone is welcome, regardless of singing experience. For more information, please contact Claire on 07751 371800 or Fionnuala on 07966 409372.

TEAM HOPE FUNDRAISING GARDEN PARTY – Friday 4 Sept, 2.00 – 7.00pm, 30 Lurganbuoy Road, Castlederg. Live music with Macdara O'Dwyer. Tea, coffee, treats, raffle – supported by local businesses – garden games, fun for children and families. Deborah Lowry wishes you to know that everyone is welcome and you can drop in at any time during the afternoon or evening.

Our prayers are asked for the happy repose of the souls of those recently enrolled in the Derry Diocesan Society:

Aghyaran: Peter Moss, Scraghey Road; Madge McNamee, Meelmore Drive, Omagh.

Drumquin: Paddy Gallagher, Tattysalagh Road; Finola Scott, Meelmore Drive, Omagh.

Ardstraw West and Castlederg: Charlie Logue, Castlefin Park; Christine Clarke, 120 Lenagh Road, Omagh



clonmanyparish.ie

PARISH MASS AND PRAYER SCHEDULE

ST MARY’S CHURCH, CLONMANY

- Monday—Thursday 9:30am Mass
- Friday 7:30pm Vigil Mass (Aug 15th)
- Confessions from 7pm
- Saturday 11:30am Mass & 6:30pm Vigil Mass
- Confessions from 6pm
- Sunday 11:30am
- Wednesday: *Exposition of The Blessed Sacrament 2:30pm—3:30pm in the room behind the Sanctuary*

ST MICHAEL’S CHURCH, URRIS

- Saturday (Aug 15) 10am Mass
- Sunday: 10am Mass
- Friday: *Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament 3-6pm*

ORATORY OF THE ASSUMPTION, BALLYLIFFIN

- Tuesday: *Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament 7:30—8:30pm*

MASS INTENTIONS THIS WEEK

6:30pm Vigil Mass—Mary Harkin, Upper Glebe
10am Mass, St Mary’s—Sheila & Louise Joyce
10am Mass, St Michael’s—Neil & Eddie Friel, Dunaff

ANNIVERSARIES

Corney Conaghan, Letter; Daniel Toland, Gaddyduff;
Patrick McGonigle, Cloontagh; Nellie Doherty & Mary O’Keefe.

FIRST ANNIVERSARY MASS

7:30pm Vigil Mass in St Mary’s Church on Friday August 14 will be offered for Patrick Gallen, Main Street, Clonmany, on the first anniversary of his death. May he RIP.

CHANGE OF MASS TIME THIS SUNDAY

Mass in St Mary’s Church on Sunday August 9 will be at the earlier time of 10am instead of 11:30am.

VOCATIONS

For our seminarians and the men considering priesthood that, in moments of doubt, they'll hear Jesus say what He says to the disciples in today's gospel, "Courage! It is I. Do not be afraid!"

SAINTS OF THE WEEK

Monday: St Lawrence, Deacon & Martyr
Tuesday: St John Clare
Wednesday: St Jane Frances de Chantal, St Muredach, St Attracta, & St Lelia. Thursday: St Pontian & St Fachtna
Friday: St Maximilian Kolbe
Saturday: The Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary

SYMPATHY

We offer sincere sympathy to the families and friends of Sarah McGonigle, Roxtown and John Doherty, Cregnagore who died during the week. May they rest in peace.

BAPTISM

We welcome into God’s family through holy baptism Thea Bridie Coulson, Cloontagh.



Clonmany Parish Newsletter

Fr John McDevitt PP Tel 0749376273 or 085 8237119

Fr Karl Haan CC Tel 0749379107

Parish Office Tel 0749376114 Email: clonmanyparish1@outlook.com



40 HOURS ADORATION

Will take place in St Michael’s Church, Urris this weekend, Sat Aug 8 & Sun Aug 9 opening with 9:30am Mass on Saturday until 5pm. Continuing after 10am Mass on Sunday and closing with a holy hour from 6-7pm. We invite people to offer some time in adoration during the two days. There is a sheet on the table at the back of the church where volunteers can fill in their name on whatever day or time suits to spend some time in the presence of the Blessed Sacrament. There should always be someone present in the Church while the Blessed Sacrament is exposed.



DAY OF PRAYER FOR MARRIAGE AND FAMILY LIFE

Friday August 14 is our Day of Prayer for Marriage & Family Life. The theme is praying for all single people and highlighting their vocation. Every baptised person, from the youngest baby to the oldest woman and man, has an important vocation which comes from the wonderful gift of baptism that each of us has been called to. In August we can focus on how this applies to those who are single and maybe even living alone.

COLLECTION

Parish collection last weekend amounted to €2,405. Thank you for your continued generosity.

DONEGAL PRO LIFE

Annual Church Gate Collection will be taken up on Saturday Aug 15 & Sunday Aug 16 countywide. If you can help in taking up a collection it would be appreciated. Contact Margaret on 0892469599. Míle buíochas.

BLESSING OF GRAVES

Annual Blessing of Graves will take place on Sunday August 16 in Clonmany Cemetery at 3pm, Cleagh Cemetery 4pm & Urris Cemetery 5pm. A collection will be taken up to support the upkeep of the cemeteries.

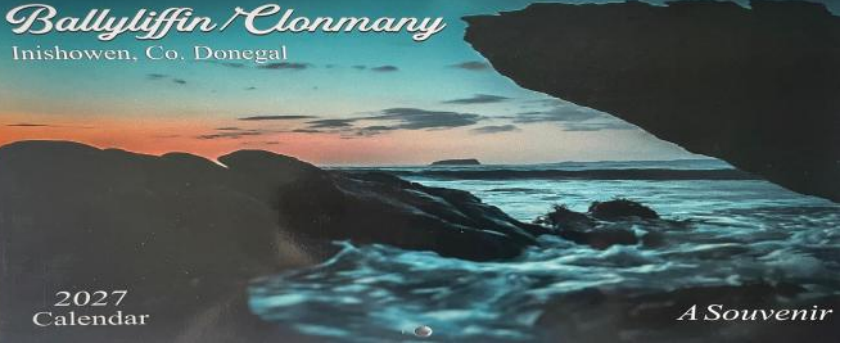
SLIABH SNEACHT CENTRE NOTES

Drumfries Walking Group will be meet on Friday Aug 14 at the car park in Ballyliffin village at 10am—everyone welcome. Wheelchair (Hippocampe) here at the centre, free service and ideal for family/friends visiting over the summer, to access local beaches, scenic walks and festivals. To book this service please Tel 0749361742.

ROSARY

The Rosary continues on Wednesday at 8:30pm at the Grotto in St Mary’s Church, Clonmany—All welcome as we pray for peace.

NOWDOC—6pm Friday—8am Monday—Call 0818400911



BALLYLIFFIN TIDY TOWNS 2027 CALENDAR

Twelve stunning photographs of beautiful Inishowen! Only €7 100% local production. Ideal present to be posted around the world to your family and friends! Available for sale locally at Centras, Nacey’s Barn, Atlantic Stores, Maple, Ballyliffin, & Clonmany Post Office. We can also post to you, or anywhere in the world on your behalf! Contact us at ballyliffintidytown@gmail.com to order.

JOB OPPORTUNITY:

Derry Diocesan Trust - Clonmany Parish: Administrative & Financial Officer. Hours of work: 9 hours per week. This is a job-share role. Place of work: Parish Office, Clonmany. For full details and application pack, email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop’s House, St Eugene’s Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12noon Tuesday 11 August 2026. *Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.*

PARISH DRAW RESULTS FOR JULY

- | | |
|--|-------------------|
| 1st €1,000 Marie Coady, Riverside Park | PROMOTERS |
| 2nd €150 Margaret Grant, Annaugh | Sarah Doherty |
| 3rd €150 Hubert Doherty, Coolcross | Fearghal Harkin |
| 4th €150 Ellen Doherty, 32 Gaddyduff | Charlie McGroarty |
| 5th €150 Michael & Roisin Toland, Rashenny | Bridie McDaid |
| 6th €150 Michelle Smyth, Leenan | Nora Ivers |
| 7th €100 Cian McConologue, Australia | Elizabeth Doherty |
| 8th €100 Coyle Family, Cleagh | Sarah Doherty |
| 9th €100 Anne Noone, Ard, Cloontagh | Bridie McDaid |
| 10th €100 Patrick Friel, Dunaff | Nora Ivers |

Thank you to our promoters and everyone who supports the parish draw. Profit for the month of July was €740. Anyone who wishes to join contact a promoter or the Parish Office Tel 074 9376114.



Assumption of Mary
August 15

Saturday August 15—The Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary

7:30pm Vigil Mass in St Mary’s Church on Fri Aug 14

10am Mass in St Michael’s Church, Urris on Sat Aug 15

11:30am Mass in St Mary’s Church on Sat Aug 15

The Feast of the Assumption is a day of joy. God has won. Love has won. It has won life. Love has shown that it is stronger than death, that God possesses the true strength in goodness and love. Mary was taken up body and soul into heaven. We have a Mother in heaven, the Mother of God, the Mother of the Son of God, is our Mother. He himself has said so. He made her our Mother when he said to the disciples and to all of us: ‘Behold, your Mother!’ We have a Mother in heaven.

Heaven is open, heaven has a heart. Mary spoke with God’s words, she thought with God’s words, her thoughts were God's thoughts, her words, God’s words. She was penetrated by divine light and this is why she was so resplendent, so good, so radiant with love and goodness. Being in God and with God, she is close to each one of us, knows our hearts, can hear our prayers, can help us with her motherly kindness and has been given to us, as the Lord said, precisely as a ‘mother’ to whom we can turn at any moment. She always listens to us, she is always close to us, and being Mother of the Son, participates in the power of the Son and in his goodness. We can always entrust the whole of our lives to this Mother, who is not far from any one of us.

Rosary at the holy well of St. Eigne in Mamore Gap at 3pm on Sat Aug 15
All welcome.



Culdaff
Fr. John McDevitt P.P. 9376273 / 0858237119

Fr. Karl Haan C.C. 9379107

www.culdaffparish.com

email: culdaffnotes@gmail.com

Daily Mass

Monday 7.30 pm; **Tuesday & Wednesday**, 10 am
[Blessed Sacrament Exposition after 10 am Mass until 2 pm]; **Thursday** 7.30 pm; **Friday** 10am; **Saturday** 11 am

Saturday Vigil 8 pm
Sunday 10 am.

Anniversary Mass this weekend

Sunday, 10 am Seamus McDermott, Leitrim, Gleneely

Next Weekend

Sunday 10 am Bernard McGuinness, Culdaff

Weekly Offering €870

Development Collection €265.

Envelopes can be left in McGuinness' shop.

First Reading

Isaiah 56:1,6-7

The Lord reveals his salvation to all.

Second Reading

Romans 11:13-15,29-32

God's favour to Israel is irrevocable.

Gospel Reading

Matthew 15:21-28

Jesus heals the daughter of the Canaanite woman because of her great faith.

We welcome into our Faith Community through the Sacrament of Baptism: **Ronán Thomas McLaughlin, 26 Gaelic Pk, Carndonagh.** A son for Eamon & Arlene.



The National Novena to Our Lady of Knock takes place at Knock Shrine from Thursday 13 to Friday 21 August 2026. Novena ceremonies will be celebrated daily at 3.00pm and 8.00pm, with workshops and guided prayer sessions also taking place throughout the nine days.

This year's theme is **"Sheltered in God's Love."**

See the full programme at: <https://www.knockshrine.ie/national-novena-2026-guest-speakers-and-programme/>

VOCATIONS: That the men called to priesthood will "...have a care for justice [and] act with integrity..." as they preach the message of God's salvation for everyone, the Good News that the Church is "...a house of prayer for all the peoples."

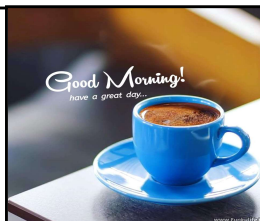
40 Hours Adoration – next Saturday 22nd & Sunday 23rd August.



The 40 Hours will begin after 11 am Mass next Saturday, and continue until 8 pm; Sunday begins after 10 am Mass and ends with a conducted Holy Hour from 6 pm-7 pm.

Sheets are available at the back of the church, in half hour slots, to ensure that there is always someone present with the Blessed Sacrament. If you can commit to one of these slots, please enter your name opposite your preferred half-hour.

Coffee Morning, Friday 21st August, in Serenity House – 10 am-2 pm. Hosted by Anne Mullan, in aid of the Letterkenny Oncology Department.



Whist: 1st Carmel McLaughlin, 2nd Fr Jim, 3rd Rose Thompson
Tickets Carmel McLaughlin, Gerard Doherty, Eileen Gormley, John Doherty, Mary B McLaughlin, Patrick McLaughlin
Other Winners Eileen Gormley, Vincent Lynn, Kathleen McDonald, Bridgid McCauley, Carmel McLaughlin.

A Feast of Folk with Patsy Cavanagh and friends every Tuesday evening at 8pm during July and August in The Cairn Greencastle. Enquiries tel 074 9381104

GREENCASTLE CENTRE - Bridge Builders FREE Adventure Camp (25th, 26th & 27th August) Ages 13–16yrs bushcrafts, coasteering, and outdoor adventures!

- Baby Reflexology with Chantel starting Tuesday 1st September 0863137817 to register your interest.

- QQI Level 5 Certificate in Healthcare Support starting in September.

Car boot sale on Saturday 5th Sept in Malin G.A.A training pitch. Commencing from 9am to 1pm. €10 per car boot. Money going toward Marinwood, The Field Group. A great way to support the club, either by buying or selling something. Sure to be a great event. Hope to see you all there.

Charity walk. From Carn to Malin on Sunday 13th September at 12pm. Meeting in the diamond in Carn at 11:45 am. Adults : €10, Kids : €5, Family : €20
All proceeds in aid of Malinwood, The Field Group.
Get your walking shoes on and join in the fun !!!

Altar Society Rota is on the Noticeboard at the back of the church



Carrowmenagh Community Centre Tel 074 93 67061

Cream Teas available at the Centre every Tuesday 2-4pm, during August. Cost €5. No need to book - just call in.
Carrowmenagh Community Centre will host The Holiday Hop, a special summer Sunday night dance for regulars, holiday makers and visitors, on Sunday 16th August at 8pm. Admission €5, including supper. Everyone is very welcome.

Celebrate Carrowmenagh – Join Carrowmenagh Community Centre, Carrowmenagh Residents Association and Tremone Historical Society for a special afternoon celebrating the heritage, people and stories of Carrowmenagh. The event will take place on **Sunday 30th August at 2pm**. It includes a guided historical village walk, talks on the stories behind the new memorial plaques in the recently renovated memorial garden and at the Centre, a cream tea, and entry into a prize draw to win an original painting by local artist Jenny Craven. All proceeds will support the Carrowmenagh Residents Association and the Memorial Garden Renovation Fund. **Tickets €10 children €5. Booking is essential through Carrowmenagh Community Centre.**

We have lots of great **courses** coming up for the autumn including beauty therapy, upholstery, plumbing, phone photography, dressmaking and alterations, pottery, creative painting, guitar lessons, tablet and smartphone for beginners, crafts, silversmithing, line dancing, glass fusion and Internet Skills. Contact the Centre for more information and to book.

The Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary 15 August 2026

The Taj Mahal has been described as a 'love song in marble.' Completed in 1645, the magnificent marble mausoleum was built by Shah Jahan, India's Mogul emperor, in memory of his favorite wife, Mumtaz Mahal (= 'the chosen one of the palace').

Her maiden name was Princess Arjumand. Shah Jahan loved her deeply, calling her his 'Taj Mahal,' meaning 'The Pearl of the Palace.' But Princess Mumtaz Mahal died giving birth to their fourteenth child, and the emperor was inconsolable. So, he summoned a great architect from Persia to build the Taj Mahal, telling him that it must be 'the one perfect memorial in the world.' Seventeen years were needed to build this enchanting edifice of gleaming white marble embroidered with flashing jewels. It is an enduring monument to love that still inspires tourists, artists, and writers from all over the world.

This beautiful love story gives us some idea of how much God must have loved Mary, the mother of Jesus. Today's feast of her Assumption into Heaven is proof of this.

By raising her from the dead and taking her into Heaven – body and soul – God demonstrated His undying love for Mary. Like Shah Jahan, God could not bear the death of His beloved. However, God could do what no Indian emperor could do – raise His beloved from the dead and restore her to life even more beautiful than before.

Moreover, God didn't have to build a Taj Mahal to memorialize Mary. Her glorified body is itself a magnificent temple of the Holy Spirit. (Albert Cylwicki in His Word Resounds).

Fr Tony Kadavil

<http://www.culdaffparish.com>

Heritage at Risk Culdaff

A talk to raise awareness about two ancient monuments in our local area and the threats they face.

TEMPLE OF DEEN & BOCAN STONE CIRCLE



 WEDNESDAY 19 AUGUST 2026	 6.00PM – 8.00PM	 TALK WITH LOCAL HISTORIANS Sean Beattie & Neil Mc Grady	 THE WEE HALL Shore Road, Culdaff, Co. Donegal F93 Y3SP	 FREE EVENT
ORGANISED BY CULDUFF DEVELOPMENT ASSOCIATION Working to promote, protect and enhance our local heritage				
FOR MORE INFORMATION				

POINTS TO PONDER

We admire the mother or father who really fights for their child. They won't take no for an answer if their child is being bullied or treated unjustly in any way, they will fight for the best medical treatment for their sick child. The woman in the gospel is like that.

She has a sick child and really wants healing. Who would not want the same? She almost forces Jesus into curing her little daughter. Her persistence is an effect of her faith, and because of her faith Jesus cures her child.

'Dogs' was a name for the Gentiles – and in this story the woman plays on its meaning to get Jesus to feed the dogs and, in this way, care for her.

Maybe this is a 'change moment' for Jesus when he realises through this poor woman that he is sent not only to his own lost ones, but that his mission is for the whole world.

This is not the first biblical figure to argue with the Lord: Genesis and Exodus tell of times when Abraham and Moses gave out to God. This woman is different from the scribes who often tried to trap Jesus with arguments.

She is begging for her daughter. There is something teasing and humorous about Jesus' first reply to her. He enjoyed that Semitic style of thrust and counter.

His first response is what we often experience in prayer: no give. But a mother seeking health for her child is not easily deterred, and Jesus rewards her persistence – I imagine him smiling as he blesses her.

Culmore Parish Newsletter

Eighteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Sunday 2nd August 2026

Thoughts on the Gospel

Matthew 14:13–21 – The Feeding of the Five Thousand

The miracle of the loaves and fishes begins with **compassion**. Before Jesus fed the crowd, He first recognised their suffering and their need. His heart was moved by those who were tired, hungry, and searching for hope.

In our own busy lives, God gently calls us to notice those around us who may be lonely, discouraged, forgotten, or struggling. A simple word of encouragement, a listening ear, or a small act of kindness may become someone else's miracle.

The disciples looked only at what they **didn't have**. Faced with thousands of hungry people, they saw only five loaves and two fish. Jesus, however, asked them to offer what they already possessed.

God rarely asks us for what we do not have. Instead, He asks us to place before Him our time, our talents, our compassion, and our willingness to serve. However small these gifts may seem, He is able to multiply them beyond anything we could imagine.

Before distributing the food, Jesus lifted everything to His Father in prayer. This reminds us that surrender is not a sign of weakness or defeat. Rather, it is an act of trust. We all carry burdens that feel too heavy or situations that seem impossible, yet when we place them into God's hands, what appears insufficient can become more than enough.

Finally, the twelve baskets of leftovers remind us of God's overwhelming generosity. His blessings are never intended to stop with us but to flow through us. When we forgive generously, encourage freely, and share what we have with others, God's grace continues to multiply in countless lives.

Prayer

Lord, fill our hearts with compassion. Use the little we have to accomplish great things for Your Kingdom. Teach us to trust You completely, to surrender our limitations into Your hands, and to share Your blessings generously with all whom we meet. Amen.

Readings for Next Sunday

Sunday 9th August 2026

First Reading: 1 Kings 19:9a, 11–13a

Psalm: Psalm 85:9–14

Second Reading: Romans 9:1–5

Gospel: Matthew 14:22–33

Saints of the Coming Week

Tuesday

- St John Vianney, Priest

Wednesday

- The Dedication of the Basilica of St Mary Major (Rome)

Thursday

- The Transfiguration of the Lord

Friday

- St Cajetan, Priest
- St Sixtus II, Pope, and Companions, Martyrs

Saturday

- St Dominic, Priest
-

Pope's Prayer Intention for August

For Evangelisation in the City

Let us pray that in large cities, often marked by anonymity and loneliness, we may discover new ways of proclaiming the Gospel, finding creative paths to build genuine Christian communities.

Prayer for Vocations

We pray for men whom God is calling to the priesthood.

Like Jesus in today's Gospel, may they never turn away from the poor, the hungry, the vulnerable or those most in need, but always reflect the compassionate love of Christ as they nourish His people through the Word of God and the Eucharist.

Parish & Diocesan Notices

Rosary on the Coast

Today (Sunday) at 3.00 pm

 Lisfannon Beach

Praying for **peace, Ireland and our unborn children.**

Everyone is warmly welcome.

Give Blood – Save Lives

The **Northern Ireland Blood Transfusion Service** will hold a blood donor session at:

Lisneal College

70 Crescent Link

Derry BT47 5FQ

Monday 4th August

- 12.30 pm – 4.00 pm
- 5.00 pm – 7.30 pm

 Freephone: **0808 553 4653** to book.

Franciscan Friary, Rossnowlagh

Monthly Healing Service

Today (Sunday)

- Rosary – **2.45 pm**
 - Mass & Healing Service – **3.00 pm**
 - Confessions – **2.00 pm – 5.00 pm**
-

ACCORD Marriage Preparation

Marriage preparation courses are available throughout the year.

Please visit www.accordni.com for dates and booking information.

Monthly Mass for Sr Clare Crockett

Sunday 9th August

7.00 pm

Carmelite Retreat Centre
Termonbacca, Derry

Day of Healing & Prayer

House of Prayer, Clonfert

Saturday 15th August

Led by **Eddie Stone**

A bus will travel from **Letterkenny**, collecting pilgrims in **Ballybofey** and **Donegal Town**.
A priest will accompany the pilgrimage.

 **Contact: 086 393 6547**

Walk in Our Patron Saint's Footsteps

St Patrick's Way Pilgrim Walk

Saturday 8th August

9.00 am – 3.00 pm

Downpatrick

Guides:

- Martina Purdy
- Elaine Kelly

Cost: £55

 **028 4461 9000**

Visit www.saintpatrickcentre.com

Youth & Young Adults

Embrace the Grace

Legion of Mary Young Adult Catholic Conference

(Ages 18–40)

Saturday 29th August

9.30 am – 6.00 pm

De Montfort House
Morning Star Avenue
Dublin D07 VA03

Tickets available through Eventbrite (search **Embrace the Grace**).

Youth 2000 Summer Festival

13th–16th August

Newbridge College, Kildare

Young people aged **16–35** are invited to enjoy:

- Inspiring talks
- Workshops
- Daily Mass
- Music and Prayer
- Fellowship
- Free buses
- All meals included

Visit **youth2000.ie** or follow **@Youth2000Ireland**.

Anam Óg Summer Scheme

3rd–7th August

12.00 pm – 4.00 pm daily

Termonbacca, Derry

For children aged **8–14**

Faith, friendship, games, arts & crafts, adventure and prayer.

Email:

termonbaccaderry@ocd.ie

Community & Charity

Mary's Meals

Annual Step by Step Walk

Sunday 9th August

12.00 noon

Starting from:

Sainsbury's Car Park

Strand Road, Derry

Walking the Foyle Bridge and Peace Bridge.

Everyone is welcome—even if only for part of the walk.

Mary's Meals currently provides a daily school meal to **over 3 million children across 16 countries.**

Please keep all participants in your prayers.

Family Carers Ireland

Remote one-to-one support clinics are available **every Tuesday throughout August.**

Carers can speak privately from the comfort of their own homes.

 **086 836 3842**

 **Donegalcs@familycarers.ie**

Pro-Life Events

Donegal Pro Life Church Gate Collection

Saturday 15th & Sunday 16th August

Countywide Collection

Volunteers are greatly appreciated.

 Margaret:
00353 89 246 9599

Míle buíochas.

Monthly Pro-Life Witness

Friday 7th August
1.00 pm – 2.00 pm

Roundabout at Letterkenny University Hospital.

Everyone welcome.

Pilgrimages

Lough Derg Annual Fundraising Draw

Support Station Island and help preserve this special place of pilgrimage for future generations.

Tickets

- Single: **€10**
- Book of 6: **€50**

Those returning a full book will also be entered into the **Early Bird Draw on 28th August 2026.**

Main Draw

23rd October 2026

Prizes

 €10,000

 €5,000

 €2,000

4th – €1,500

5th – €1,000

6th – €500

Lough Derg Day Retreats

As the Three-Day Pilgrimage season concludes (final day to begin is **13th August**), Day Retreats resume on:

- August: **18, 22, 23, 29 & 31**
- September: **5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19 & 20**

Take time away from the busyness of everyday life for guided prayer, quiet reflection and spiritual renewal.

Advance booking is essential.

Employment Opportunity

Administrative & Financial Officer

Clonmany Parish

The **Derry Diocesan Trust** invites applications for the position of:

Administrative & Financial Officer

Hours: 9 per week

Application packs are available from:

Bishop's House
St Eugene's Cathedral
Derry BT48 9AP

 028 7126 2302

 recruitment@derrydiocese.org

Closing Date: Tuesday **11th August 2026**

Publications

Reflections Through Poetry

A beautiful collection by **Fr John P. Forbes**

Available from the **Pastoral Office**

Price: £10

All proceeds support **Children in Crossfire** and the **Cause for the Canonisation of Sr Clare Crockett**.

Sharing the Good News

Read the latest weekly Catholic e-zine featuring news, reflections and resources from across Ireland.

Visit **theway.ie/ezine-2/**.

Closing Prayer

May the Lord bless us with compassionate hearts, generous spirits, and unwavering trust in His providence. May we recognise Christ in those around us, offer Him the little we possess, and witness His abundant blessings multiplying in our families, our parish, and our community.

May Almighty God bless you, the Father, ✠ the Son, and the Holy Spirit. Amen.

**Parish of Dunboe, Macosquin and
Aghadowey**

Sunday 16th August 2026
Year A Psalter Week IV



Rev Neil Farren PP. Chapelfield, 59 Laurel Hill
Road, Coleraine BT51 3PY Tele: 028 7034 3130
Parish Secretary: Clare White at Chapelfield
Office hours This week:
Tuesday 18th Aug – 09.00 – 1.00pm
Wednesday 19th Aug – 09.00 – 1.00pm
Friday 21st Aug – 09.00 – 1.00pm

Parish Email: cpdma@btinternet.com
Parish Website: www.dmaparish.com

SVP Helpline: Tel: 07752017340
Safeguarding Officer: Mrs Bernadette Eastwood

Emergency Calls: Father Neil Farren - 07710860966

Age Concern Tele 02870357966
Good morning, Causeway For elderly and vulnerable
people. Tele 02870558005
Lifeline Crisis Response Helpline 0808 808 8000
North Coast Community Transport Tele 02870321234
Samaritans Tele 116123
St Vincent de Paul Tele 07752017340
Wave Trauma Centre for Mental Health and Wellbeing
Tele 0282766990 **Women’s Aid** Tele 02870356
Onus – Men & Women affected by domestic or
sexual abuse in NI – 0808 802 1414 (Freephone 24hr)

Recently deceased

Izabela Sander (Somerset drive), Brendan Parker
(Dunboe), Matthew McDaid (Killowen St)

Derry Diocesan Society

Gerard Cuning, Robert Howard, George Laverty
Gerard (Gerry) McIlwaine, Bernadette Duncan

Months Mind

Harry Montgomery (Saturday Vigil St. John’s)
Ernie Gorham (late of Drumard Drive) - Sunday
23rd August 2026 at 11.30am St Malachys.

Anniversaries

Kathleen Ewart, Jean McGarvey, Kathleen McDaid,
Eleanor McCrory, John Eddie Mullan, Eamon Lynn,
John Lynn, Kathleen Donnelly (Anniversary Mass
17th August)

Parish Collections 8th & 9th August 2026

	St Johns	Aghadowey	Dunboe
Weekly:	£761.52	£264.80	£230.00
Loose:	£334.79	£33.45	£32.78
Total:	£1657.34		

Masses - week commencing 17th August

Church	St Johns	Dunboe	Aghadowey
Monday	10am		
Tuesday	10am		
Wednesday			
Thursday	10am		
Friday			
Saturday	6pm		9.45am
Sunday	11am		

Dunboe Reader/ Offertory Rota

Saturday 15th August – Ann / Offertory – Martin &
Marian
Saturday 22nd August – Brenda / Offertory – Liam &
Ann
Saturday 29th August – Catherine / Offertory – Seamus
& Linda

Dunboe Eucharistic Minister Rota

Saturday 15th August – Linda
Saturday 22nd August – Karen
Saturday 29th August – Maggie
Saturday 5th September - Vincent
Dunboe Cleaning & Flowers Rota
August– Martina Doherty

St Johns Eucharistic Minister

Saturday 22nd August – John McKeefry
Sunday 23rd August – Rosemary Devlin
St Johns Minister of the Word August
Vigil: Carmel
Sunday Mass: Phaedra

Aghadowey Offertory

Sunday 16th August – Bill & Eilish
Sunday 23rd August – Christopher & Kathleen Owens
Sunday 30th August – Paddy & Violet Dempsey

We Pray

That the men called to priesthood will "...have a care for
justice and act with integrity..." as they preach the message
of God's salvation for everyone, the Good News that the
Church is "...a house of prayer for all the peoples."

Sick Visitation

Aritclave / Dunboe - Monday



PARISH TRIP

Our Parish Day trip is now fully booked.

The bus will depart **West Bann community centre at 8am**
sharp and is scheduled to return by 8.00 – 8.30pm

All monies should now have been paid, however if
there is any still outstanding, please forward over
this weekend.

If you have not yet made your meal choice, please
either contact the Parish Office or call in to the
Sacristy in St Johns to select choice of evening
meal –

Main course

***Atlantic tempura battered Cod with chips & either**
mushy peas or side salad.
***Beef Lasagne with chips & side salad**

Dessert

***Warm apple pie served with either custard, ice**
cream or fresh cream
***Homemade lemon posset served with shortbread**

Tea / Coffee

ST JOSEPH MEN’S CAMINO (BOYNE VALLEY)

25KM • ONE DAY • ONE PILGRIMAGE

A pilgrimage that will test the body,
enlighten the mind and
strengthen the soul

**Saturday,
12 September**
**Drogheda,
Co. Louth**

 Holy Mass

 Adoration

 Confessions

 Fraternity

Walking the historic **Boyne Valley** route.
AFTER DINNER SPEAKER Fr Mark Quinn,
founder of **Men of St Joseph**
Tuam archdioceses

COST
€65 (includes
lunch and dinner)
Students: €55
Men aged 18+ only

 Book now and find full details at:
Dominicans.ie

 Organised by the Dominican Friars and Friends.

AMRI

Leaders of missionaries & religious of Ireland.

Representatives from AMRI will be talking at Masses on
the weekend of 15th/16th August to speak of their
missionary work and appeal for donations

OB OPPORTUNITY, DERRY DIOCESAN

TRUST: Administrative & Financial Officer

(18 hours per week), Waterside Parish, Parochial
House, 32 Chapel Road, Derry. Rate of pay: £12.88
per hr - £13.50 per hr.

For application packs please email:
recruitment@derrydiocese.org or tel 028 7126
2302. Completed applications must be returned to
Personnel, Bishop’s House, St Eugene’s Cathedral,
Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to
recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12 noon
Monday 24 August 2026.

*Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities
Employer. We welcome applications from all men and
women and from members of all communities.*

BABY MASSAGE & REFLEXOLOGY CLASSES

Next Block of Classes start in September 2026.
Taster Session available on 28th & 29th July (£10 per
session)
Reflexology Treatments Available for all ages.
Location: Ballerin.
Contact Diane on 07761054666 or
diane@groundedsoles.org for more information

Safeguarding Notice

If you have any concerns with regard to the
Safeguarding of children within the Church please
contact Marie O’Kane, the Diocesan Designated
Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email:
dlp@derrydiocese.org Northern Ireland
emergency services PSNI (Police Service of
Northern Ireland) 101 Social Services: Gateway
Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 7131 4090 (and
ask for the Duty Social Worker) Gateway Services,
Northern HSC Trust 028 9442 4459 Regional
Emergency Social Work Services 0800 1979 995
Republic of Ireland emergency services Garda
Síochána Buncrana: 00353 749 320 540

Rosary on the coast

This Sunday 16th August – Benone Beach at 3pm
All are very welcome to attend

SUNDAY 16 AUGUST 2026

Twentieth Sunday Ordinary Time

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:
Aghyaran • Ardstraw West & Castlederg • Drumquin

REV PAUL FRASER PP, Tel:028 816 71393; REV THOMAS CANNING CC, Tel: 028 82831 225

SCHEDULE FOR THIS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday 17 August		Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm	Mass, 10.00am Rosary, 8.00pm at Grotto
Tuesday 18 August	Mass, 10.00am		
Wednesday 19 August			Mass, 10.00am
Thursday 20 August	Mass, 10.00am		
Friday 21 August		Mass, Castlederg: 10.00am	
Saturday 22 August	Vigil Mass, 7.30pm: <i>Month's Mind, Danny Gallen</i>	Vigil Mass, Castlederg, 6.15pm	Vigil Mass: 5.00pm
Sunday 23 August	<i>Mass on 1st, 3rd and 5th Sunday</i>	Mass: Dregish, 9.30am Castlederg, 11.00am Drumnabey, 12.30pm	<i>Mass on 1st, 3rd and 5th Sunday</i>

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:

AGHYARAN: £835 & €41. **Church Restoration Fund:** £616 & €37.

ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £2,440 & €48, made up of:

Castlederg £1,641 & €41, **Drumnabey** £417 & €7, **Dregish** £382. **DRUMQUIN:** £464.

Thank you, as always, to all who contribute by Standing Order.

EMBRACE THE GRACE' Legion of Mary Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August, 9.30am – 6.00pm: a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion HQ at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. Tickets cost €20 and can be booked on eventbrite website - look up 'Embrace the Grace'. Any queries can be directed to deusetpatria@gmail.com.

SONGS FROM HOME - Join with local singers to celebrate our cultural roots in Tyrone - learn to sing songs written about Tyrone by people who were born here. Perform them as part of a song and story path in the Ulster American Folk Park, Omagh, on Saturday 11 October, 10.30am – 2.00pm. Rehearsal dates are: Wed 19 Aug, 7.30pm - 9.30pm - Silverbirch Hotel; Sun 30 August, 1.00 - 4.00pm - Dromore Sports Complex; Wed 23 Sept, 7.30pm - 9.30pm - Silverbirch Hotel; Wed 30 Sept, 7.30pm - 10.00pm - Dromore Sports Complex; Wed 7 Oct, 7.30pm - 9.30pm - Silverbirch Hotel. Everyone is welcome, regardless of singing experience. For more information, please contact Claire on 07751 371800 or Fionnuala on 07966 409372.

TEAM HOPE FUNDRAISING GARDEN PARTY – Friday 4 Sept, 2.00 – 7.00pm, 30 Lurganbuoy Road, Castlederg. Live music with Macdara O'Dwyer. Tea, coffee, treats, raffle – supported by local businesses – garden games, fun for children and families. Deborah Lowry wishes you to know that everyone is welcome and you can drop in at any time during the afternoon or evening.

Our prayers are asked for the happy repose of the souls of those recently enrolled in the Derry Diocesan Society:

Aghyaran: Peter Moss, Scraghey Road; Madge McNamee, Meelmore Drive, Omagh.

Drumquin: Paddy Gallagher, Tattysalagh Road; Finola Scott, Meelmore Drive, Omagh.

Ardstraw West and Castlederg: Charlie Logue, Castlefin Park; Christine Clarke, 120 Lenagh Road, Omagh

**Eighteenth Sunday in
Ordinary Time**

2nd August 2026



Parish of Drumragh

**Sacred Heart Church, Omagh
St Mary's Church, Drumragh
028 82242092**

Weekend Mass Schedule

Sacred Heart Church, Omagh Vigil: 5.30pm Sunday Mass: 10am & 12.30pm	<u>Weekday Mass Times this week</u> 10.00am Monday, Tuesday & Wednesday in St. Mary's, Killyclogher 10.00am Wed, Thurs, Fri & Sat. in Sacred Heart Church 7.30pm Wednesday Sacred Heart <u>Eucharistic Adoration on Wednesday from 10am until 6.45pm.</u> <u>Rosary before 7.30pm Mass</u>
St. Mary's Church, Drumragh Sunday Mass: 10.30am	
Confessions: Sacred Heart Church: Saturday's after morning Mass unless there is a funeral. Christ the King, Strathroy: Saturday 6.15pm-6.45pm	

REST A WHILE

In our day-to-day life's journey, oftentimes we are overwhelmed with our daily routines, individual tasks as well as duties and responsibilities. It seems that the 24 hours of the day are not enough because we are too busy with so many things. We do not have time to "stop and smell the roses." We do not have time to relax and to take time out of our busy schedules to appreciate and enjoy God's gift of the beauty of life. We need time to rest, to recognise our human limitations that we need essential respite to prevent us from being exhausted and to avoid the possible danger of breakdown. According to the mechanical engineers, even machines need cooling-off time to prevent overheating. When we approach our "hallowed space" like spending time praying in front of the Blessed Sacrament or lighting candles inside the church, we are refreshed and strengthened. We will be inspired to go on despite all the burdens, challenges, and obstacles in life. That is why after the tiresome and successful mission of the Apostles the Lord told them, "Come away by yourselves to a deserted place and rest a while." Following Jesus' command, these first followers were spiritually and physically recharged to do the next job. We also badly need to have some "refreshment" of the Lord and to spend time with Him in silent prayer to find meaning in every life's situation. In this way, we are far from being "worn out" and preventing ourselves from "falling apart." And so, let us all find time to relax and rest for a while with Him.



Mass times for Sat. 15th August (Feast of the Assumption)

Vigil 7.30pm Friday 14th – Christ the King, Strathroy

10am Saturday 15th Sacred Heart Church & St Mary's, Killyclogher

Fr Kevin McElhennon P.P: 028 8225 8108 / k.mcelhennon@derrydiocese.org
 Fr Malachy Gallagher C.C: 028 8225 1055 / malachy.gallagher@derrydiocese.org
 Parish Office, Omagh 028 8224 2092 / info@drumraghparish.com
 Cappagh Parish Office 028 8224 3375 / info@cappaghparish.com

Parish Office Closed until Monday 24th August

Parish email: info@drumraghparish.com

Sacred Heart Church Mass Intentions

Wednesday 5th August	7.30pm	Louise Rodgers - Month Mind Kevin McCrory - 1st Anniversary Martin McDonagh - 5th Anniversary
Saturday 8th August	5.30pm	Marie Chesters - 6th Anniversary
Wednesday 12th August	7.30pm	Brenda Drumm - Month Mind
Wednesday 19th August	7.30pm	Eamon McAlynn - 2nd Anniversary
Thursday 20th August	10.00am	Joseph Martin - 3rd Anniversary

ST. MARY'S, DRUMRAGH Mass Intentions

Sunday 16th August 10.30pm Paddy (Patricia) Doherty – 1st Anniversary

VOCATIONS

We pray for the men called to priesthood. Like Jesus in today's gospel, may they never turn away from the poor, the hungry, the most vulnerable, or those in need, but always reflect the love of Christ for them as they nourish and strengthen them with the Word of God.

Sacrament of Baptism

We welcome new members of our Parish Community who received the

Sacrament of Baptism:

Mabel Frances McGale

Callen Brendan Gray

Tadhg Michael Drumm

Poppy Leslie Paula Marshall

Cadhla Jacqueline Finnegan



Recently Deceased

Patricia Daly

Louisa Brochet (nee Kelly)

May they rest in peace



Recent Weddings

We congratulate the following couple who were married here recently



Kerrie Anne O'Hagan & Ronan Grogan

May the grace of the sacrament remain with them all their lives.



Eucharistic Ministers will bring Holy Communion to the sick and housebound next **Sunday 9th August**

Derry Diocesan Society

The following names have been added to the list of Deceased Members of the Derry Diocesan Society

Martin Gerard Rodgers

Rene Colton

Charles (Edmund) Fisher

James (Anthony) McCauley

William (Billy) Wilson

Michelle McElhill

Seamus McGlone

Ann Marie Taggart

Alice Oddy

Mary Maguire

Padriag Doherty

Veronica Conroy

Kevin McCaskie

Shareen McNamee

Gary Oddy

Carmel Rippington

Edward McGlinchey

We pray that all who sleep in Christ find in your presence, light, happiness and peace.

BINGO in St. Joseph's Hall continues on Tuesday's during August at 8.30pm

Parish Draw

The July draw takes place this week. Promoters are asked to please make their returns before **7.30pm on Tuesday 4th August**. Please note, the deadline of 7.30pm is strict and late returns may not be accepted.

The List of August winners will be published on the noticeboard in the porch at the main door.

The Royal National institute of the deaf are holding their bimonthly free drop in event in Omagh Methodist church hall on **Thursday 27th August from 10-30 to 12.30**. Come along and have your hearing checked and new batteries provided plus advise on how to get the best from your aids.

Parish Notice – Holiday Closure

During the parish holiday closure, anyone wishing to book an Anniversary Mass, or arrange a baptism or wedding, is asked to please contact **Orla (Monday to Thursday)** in the Cappagh Office on **02882243375** or **info@cappaghparish.com**.

She will be happy to assist with all bookings during this period.

Please note there are **no** available dates in August for Baptisms in Omagh or Killyclogher.

SONGS FROM HOME

Come together with **Harmonise** and fellow local singers as we share Songs from Home. Participants must attend FREE five week choir practice followed by the Final Song Trail 10th October at Ulster American Folk Park. Refreshments provided.

EVERYONE WELCOME - Contact Claire Sharkey for more details 07751371800

Dates

August 19th	7.30pm-9.30pm – Silverbirch Hotel
August 30th	1pm-4pm – Dromore Sports Complex
September 23rd	7.30-10pm – Silverbirch Hotel
September 30th	7.30-10pm – Dromore Sports Complex
October 7th	7.30pm-9.30pm – Silverbirch Hotel

Omagh Library

Tuesday 4th August 2:00pm - 3:00pm

Create your own Comic - whether you're into superheroes or cute animals you can create your very own comic to take home with you.

For children aged 5 - 11 Years old

Children under 8 must be accompanied by an adult. Booking Essential

Monday 10th August 9:30am - 5:00pm

Calling all budding detectives! Can you help us solve the library mysteries?

Crack the code, solve the clues, and earn your detective badge.

For children aged 4 - 11 years old

Children under 8 must be accompanied by an adult. Everyone Welcome

Weekly Bulletin

Please note that throughout the month of August the parish newsletter will be published on **23rd August only**. The Parish Office will be closed until 24th August.

PUBLIC OPENING 2026 ST JOSEPH'S HALL

The Uniform Exchange will be open to the public in St Joseph's Hall from Wednesday 5th August until Sunday 9th August from 10am – 4pm each day.

For everyone – All schools from Castlederg to Ballybofey.

Good quality pre-loved uniforms, for all ages and all local schools.

NO COST / NO CHARGE The service is completely free
REUSE RELOVE REDUCE WAST



Al-Anon Family Group	028 9068 2368
Alcoholics Anonymous	028 9035 1222
Aware	028 7126 0602
Care for Cancer	028 8224 6599
Gamblers Anonymous	028 7135 1329
Drug Awareness	0800 7766 00
Legion of Mary	07733551846/07864926719
Pioneers	07775 810297
Safeguarding Team	07596 500793
Samaritans	028 8224 4944
SVDP Thrift Shop	028 8225 2000
SVDP Helpline	07738837991

**DIOCESAN SAFEGUARDING
REPRESENTATIVE**
Marie O’Kane DLP 07596500793
dlp@derrydiocese.org

GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS:

Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 028 7135 1329.

Walk in the footsteps of our Patron Saint on Saint Patrick's Way Pilgrim Walk in Downpatrick with Martina Purdy and Elaine Kelly on **8th August**. Begin at Saint Patrick's Centre with the fabulous 180° IMAX film of St Patrick. Price includes entrance fees, internal bus transfers, pilgrimage lunch at the famous Saul Barn, plus a stamped Camino passport and a 6-mile pilgrimage walk, finishing at Saint Patrick's grave. Come and Be Amazed!

(Duration 9am-approx 3pm, all for just £55) To book ring 02844 619000 or go to website www.saintpatrickcentre.com

Celebration of Christian Marriage

Any couple intending to celebrate their marriage in the church are advised to have their

(1) Pre-nuptial Enquiry Forms (canonical church papers) completed no later than 3 months prior to their wedding.

(2) Your pre-marriage course with Accord should also be completed before your papers are signed (info@accordni.com).

(3) The Marriage Schedule (civil documents) (Ref GRO 446 v06/22) should also be “served with the Registrar at least 28 days before the date of the intended marriage”. (It is recommended that all civil and canonical papers are completed no later than 3 months prior to the wedding).

16th August 2026 Dungiven Parish Bulletin No 1856

Fr. Gerard Sweeney P.P. Tel: 777 41219.

Parish Office Tel: 777 40702. Email address

dungivenparish@derrydiocese.org

Parish Website <https://www.parishofdungiven.com>**SUNDAY MASS TIMES****Sat. 4.30 pm. - Gortnaghey****Sat. 6.00 pm. - Dungiven****Sun. 9.00 am. - Dungiven****Sun. 10.15 am. - Drumsurn****Sun. 11.30 am. - Dungiven****WEEKDAY MASS TIMES****St. Patrick's:** Monday, Tuesday & Wednesday 10.00 am. **Thursday 7.00 pm.** Friday 10.00 am.**MONTH'S MIND MASSES**For Donal Kealey on Saturday 22nd August at 4.30 pm. in Imm. Conception Church, Gortnaghey.For Margaret Bond on Saturday 22nd August at 6.00 pm. in St. Patrick's Church**CONFESSIONS**

Will take place in St. Patrick's at 11.00 am. on Saturday.

THE ROSARY - Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday & Friday at 9.30 am. in St. Patrick's.**LAST WEEK'S COLLECTION: £2,926.***Thank you to all who contributed.***BAPTISM** – We welcome into our Christian Community: Úna & Éabha Butcher, Drumsurn Court; Clíodhna Ann O'Boyle, Peter's Road & Aoife Rose Brolly, O'Cathain's Place.**BAPTISM - Godparents must be over 16 years of age, one male and one female and a practicing Catholic.****Baptisms** will take place in St. Patrick's Church at 3.00 pm. *Two weeks' notice must be given for all Baptism bookings.***The Baptism Course:** Places must be booked through the Parish Office. **Next Course: Wednesday 26th August at 7.30 pm. in the Committee Room.****DEATH**

We extend our sympathy to the O'Kane family circle on the death of Ben O'Kane, Magherabuoy Terrace. May he rest in peace.

**WEDDING BELLS** - We congratulate Shauna Lynch and Kiernan McCormick on the occasion of their marriage on the 8th August 2026.**CHARISMATIC PRAYER GROUP**There will be **no meeting** on Thursday 20th August.**LEGION OF MARY**The Legion of Mary hopes to organise a Day Pilgrimage to Knock Shrine on **Sun. 28th Sept.**, subject to sufficient interest.If you would like to travel, please register your interest by texting **Mary McKnight** on **07548 887 853**, or by leaving your name with the Parish Office. The approximate bus fare will be **£25 per person.****BENEDY COMMUNITY ASSOCIATION**We wish to employ a person for 6 hours on a Monday for catering duties. Start date: Monday 7th September 2026. For full details, including rate of pay, contact Sabina on 07742217929.**ST. PATRICK'S CHURCH – CAR PARK CLOSURE****Please note: Our car park at St. Patrick's Church will be closed from Monday 17th August – Friday 21st August, for resurfacing works.****CLEANERS – ST. PATRICK'S CHURCH**
Voluntary cleaners required to clean the church on a monthly rota basis. Please leave your name in the parish office.**VOCATIONS**

That the men called to priesthood will "...have a care for justice [and] act with integrity..." as they preach the message of God's salvation for everyone, the Good News that the Church is "...a house of prayer for all the peoples."

S.V.P. HELPLINE 079 2792 9923**ALTAR SERVER – ST. PATRICK'S CHURCH**
If there are any children (In P5 and those who made their First Communion) who would like to be an Altar Server. Please make contact with Fr. Sweeney.**KEVIN LYNCH H. C.**Lotto no's: 12, 18, 21 & 26. Lucky dip: Geraldine O'Kane. Jackpot: £2,100. *Bingo: Fridays 8.00 pm. in Wanes World.***WHIST DRIVE**In St. Peter's Hall, Drumsurn today, Sunday 16th August, at 7.30 pm.**FOUND**

Bank card found in the Chapel car park. Owner can claim it at the Parish Office.

LEGION OF MARY**'Embrace the Grace' Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August 2026** - conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. It will be a chance to build faith in friendship with young adults from

across the country. This event takes place on Saturday 30 August from 9.30am to 6.00pm with a social afterwards. Tickets cost €20 and can be booked on the eventbrite website by looking up 'Embrace the Grace'. Any queries can be directed towards deusetpatria@gmail.com

DUNGIVEN LIBRARYOn Friday 21 August from 12.00 noon – 1.30 pm. – a lovely event for all the family (including grown-ups!). **And her name was Finvola...** is our week for hearing about the story behind the song 'The Gem of the Roe'. A fun storytelling session first, then **Aoife Mullan** from 'The little Music Studio' will teach us the song, accompanied by **Scarlett O'Hara** on the harp. The children will also get to draw their favourite scenes from the story. To finish off our Big Summer Read, on Friday 28 August at 12:00 noon, the children can come and get crafty in our **Animal Mask Mania** activity.Each activity takes place in our library junior section, and no booking is required. If you're interested in local history or tracing your family tree, then make sure you come to our PRONI event. On the Tuesday 18 August, **PRONI on tour** brings the Public Records Office of Northern Ireland and Libraries NI together to provide archival support and historical exhibitions in communities across Northern Ireland. This workshop at Dungiven Library this August is designed to help you get started using PRONI's online services and other resources and it's a perfect opportunity to ask questions directly to PRONI staff.

Booking is required for the workshops on the first floor of the library, but you can drop in anytime between 10:00 am - 1:00 pm or from 2:00 pm - 4:00 pm to talk to PRONI staff in the library's lobby area.

BUNCRANA PARISH GARDEN FETE The Garden Fete will take place on Sunday 23rd August in the grounds of Scoil Mhuire from 3pm-6pm. See their Facebook page for more details. All welcome

ADORATION IN ST MURA'S PARISH CHURCH on Friday after the 10am Mass. All welcome.

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS That the men called to priesthood will "...have a care for justice [and] act with integrity..." as they preach the message of God's salvation for everyone, the Good News that the Church is "...a house of prayer for all the peoples."

MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND hosted by Marriage Encounter Ireland takes place at the Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare, from Fri 2 to Sun 4 October. This is not a retreat in the traditional sense but is a positive, joy-filled experience, guided by presenting couples and a priest, in an atmosphere of warmth, prayer, and deep Christian faith. Couples are invited to register online at www.marriageencounter.ie

EMBRACE THE GRACE Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August 2026 - Legion of Mary: 'Embrace the Grace' is a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. This event is on Sat 30 August from 9.30am to 6pm with a social afterwards. Tickets cost €20 and can be booked on the eventbrite website by looking up 'Embrace the Grace'. Any queries can be directed towards deusetpatria@gmail.com.

ABIDE IN HIS LOVE WOMENS CONFERENCE The Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran, 20–22 Nov. Join women from across Ireland for a faith-filled weekend with inspiring speakers including Sarah Swafford, Danielle Noonan, Fr Mark Wharton, Fr Barry Braum, Fr Oisín Martin, the Dominican Sisters of Nashville, Bishop Fintan Gavin, and more. A conference not to be missed! Register now: <https://abideinhislove.eventbrite.com/>

THE NATIONAL NOVENA TO OUR LADY OF KNOCK takes place at Knock Shrine from Thursday 13 to Friday 21 August. Novena ceremonies will be celebrated daily at 3pm and 8pm, with workshops and guided prayer sessions also taking place throughout the nine days. This year's theme is **"Sheltered in God's Love."** See the full programme at: <https://www.knockshrine.ie/national-novena-2026-guest-speakers-and-programme/>

DONEGAL DOWN SYNDROME ASSOCIATION Annual church-gate collection will take place on the weekend of 29 /30 Aug. Anyone interested in helping on the day can contact the Donegal Down Syndrome Association office by email at info@donegal.downsyndrome.ie or call 0857870075. Your financial support for this important fundraising event would be greatly appreciated and will help in continuing to provide vital services and supports to children and adults with Down Syndrome and their families across Donegal.

BURT BINGO every Tuesday in St. Marys Hall, Burt at 9pm.

BURT'S BIG BINGO will take place Sunday 30th August at 3.00 pm in St. Mary's Hall, Burt. Two top prizes of €100. All other lines and houses are €25 and €50 respectively, except for the 9th page which is €50 for the line and €100 for the house. The sheet is €25 for the line and €100 for the house. Great raffle prizes drawn after every house. Book €12 and sheet €2. Proceeds to Parish funds. If you would like to donate prizes for the raffle contact Carmel, Ellen or contact Kathleen on 086 3931426

BURT GAA LOTTO 9-14-16-24-26 Mary Doherty and Mary Gallagher €50

LINE DANCING CLASS in St. Mary's Hall Burt every Thursday at 7.30pm. €7 per class.

SWILLY CEP are looking for grounds worker for Burt, Inch and Fahan graveyard. For information ring 0879392767

A HISTORY IN STONES This year Fahan Heritage Group invite you to explore our ancestry as told by stone on August 23 at 2.30pm at the old graveyard. After a guided tour seeing St Mura's Cross enjoy a talk on the rich history of the village dating back more than 1,000 years and its famous inhabitants and houses, followed by refreshments in St Mura's Church.

A FEAST OF FOLK MUSIC every Tuesday at 8pm. Song, story and Irish dance in the Cairn Greencastle Tel 074 9381104

Now Doc Phone Number: 0818400911. Have your Eircode handy.

PRIVACY NOTICE: The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A Privacy Notice is available on the Parish Website or by contacting The Parish Office. Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in St Mura's Church and St Aengus' are available online. Parishioners should note that the first two rows of seats are visible online for both Churches.

Fahan Parish Newsletter

Weekly Collection
Burt €1009
Inch €628
Fahan €1099
Sincere Thanks

fahanparish@derrydiocese.org
www.fahanparish.com
16th August 2026
Twentieth Sunday In Ordinary Time

Fr Bradley 9363455
Fr Baker 9360151
Parish Office 9360151
(Mon-Thurs 10am-12:30pm)

Mass Schedule

St. Aengus' Burt
(churchservices.tv/burt)
Monday 17th Aug Mass at 10am
Saturday 22nd Aug Mass at 6.30pm
Mickey Donnelly 10th Anniversary Mass

Sunday 23rd Aug Mass at 10.15am
Paddy Whoriskey, Tillie Forshaw and Noel Sweeney
Anniversary Mass

St Mura's Church, Fahan
(churchservices.tv/fahan)
Wednesday 19th Aug Mass at 7pm
Daniel Breslin 1st Anniversary Mass

Friday 21st Aug Mass at 10am
Sunday 23rd Aug Mass at 11:30am
Martin Strain 11th Anniversary Mass
Michael Ryan 14th Anniversary Mass

Our Lady of Lourdes, Inch
Sunday 23rd Aug Mass at 9am

Chapel Of Ease, Fahan
Thursday 20th Aug Mass at 10am

JOB OPPORTUNITIES

Derry Diocesan Trust -

Administrative & Financial Officer (18 hours per week), Waterside Parish,
Parochial House, 32 Chapel Road, Derry. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hr - £13.50 per hr.
For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or tel 048 7126 2302.
Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12 noon Monday 24 August 2026.

Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

CLIMB TO THE EUCHARISTIC CROSS

on Sunday 30th August meeting at the Water Tank at 1.30pm.
The Rosary will be said on the way up. All Welcome.

BAPTISMS

We welcome into God's family the following children who were baptised:
Arthur Edward Faulkner, Castle Park, Buncrana
Luca Christopher Brett, Baranduda, Victoria, Australia.
May God guide and protect our children always

DEATHS

Your prayers are asked for
Margaret Curran (nee Barr) Speenogue, Burt and
Vera McLaughlin, Tooban, Burnfoot
We pray for their families and friends saddened by their loss.

SAFEGUARDING NOTICE: If you have any concerns with regards to Safeguarding Children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) at 0044 7596500793, or at dlp@derrydiocese.org or **Garda Sióchána, Buncrana** 074 9320540 Letterkenny HQ 074 9167100 or **TUSLA Family & Child Agency** 07491 02233

Rev. Chris McDermott. Adm.

Tel: (028) 79401236

Email: christopher.mcdermott@derrydiocese.org

www.granaghanparish.com

MASS TIMES FOR THE

COMING WEEK:

Monday, Wednesday & Friday Mass

at 09:15am

Saturday (Vigil) at 4pm

Sunday Mass at 11am

GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS: Is gambling affecting your life? *We would like to help you.* Please pick up your phone and make contact - Tel: 028 7135 1329.

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The National Novena to Our Lady of Knock
 Takes place at Knock Shrine
 Thursday 13 to Friday 21 August 2026. **No-**
vena ceremonies will be celebrated daily at
 3.00pm and 8.00pm,
 With workshops and guided prayer sessions also
 taking place throughout the nine days.
 This year's theme is "Sheltered in God's Love."

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 See the full programme:
<https://www.knockshrine.ie/national-novena-2026-quest-speakers-and-programme/>

Adult Céili Dancing - Fitness, Fun, Friendship
 The Marian Hall, Kilrea
 Further Details - 07821054402
 Wednesday Evenings, 7pm - £5.00 per week

A fun way to keep active, learn Céili dancing & meet new people.

EVERYONE WELCOME

No need to book - Just come along.

MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND -

Hosted by **Marriage Encounter Ireland** will take place at the Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare, from Friday 2 to Sunday 4 October 2026. This Weekend is not a retreat in the traditional sense but is a positive, joy-filled experience, guided by presenting couples and a priest, in an atmosphere of warmth, prayer, and deep Christian faith. Couples are invited to register online at www.marriageencounter.ie

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 That the men called to priesthood will "...have a care for justice [and] act with integrity..." as they preach the message of God's salvation for everyone, the Good News that the Church is "...a house of prayer for all the peoples."
Fr Pat O'Hagan

An Carn - Introduction to Willow Weaving: Berry Basket - Perfect for those looking to make their own Berry Basket just in time for Foraging season! **Saturday 5 September | An Carn | 9:30am - 5pm | £25 | 18+**
Live Music: Na Leanai - The children and grandchildren of the **Sands Family**, a name synonymous with Irish folk music for generations, are joining us at **An Coire** for a special night of music you don't want to miss!
Date: Saturday 12 September. Doors at 7pm. Cost: £16. Under 16s: Free

Drumnaph Nature Reserve

Forest Bathing - Join us at Drumnaph for an immersive experience through **guided sensory meditations**, reconnect with the natural world and weave yourself back into nature!

Date: Saturday 29 August. Time: 10am - 12pm. Cost: £10

Weekly Collection for Sunday 9th August 2026 - Weekly: £1,256.65
Priests: £ 40.00

Twentieth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Sunday 16th August 2026

PARISH OF GRANAGHAN



St Vincent De Paul Helpline: 07927900310

Embrace the Grace - Legion of Mary Young Adult (20-40) - Catholic Conference -

Saturday 29th August 2026 from 9.30am to 6pm.

Legion of Mary De Montfort House, Morning Star Avenue, Dublin 7 DO7 VA03.

Tickets: www.eventbrite.ie.

(Search "Embrace the Grace").

Standard Ticket: €20. Early Bird Ticket bought before 1st August €15.

Any queries please contact:

deusetpatria@gmail.com



For 30 years, Children in Crossfire have been supporting and transforming the lives of some of the world's most vulnerable children by supporting overcrowded primary schools, extreme poverty / hunger. **We are asking for your support with our £1000.00 Prize Raffle.** Draw Date: Friday 14 August 2026 **Thank you!** together we can give more children the chance of a brighter future.

Link to purchase tickets: <https://www.childrenincrossfire.org/shop/summer-raffle-tickets-2026/>

Lord Jesus, You welcome all who seek You with a sincere heart. Open our eyes to see Your presence in those around us, and open our hearts to share Your mercy without limits. Strengthen our faith, so that we may persevere in prayer and trust in **Your goodness.** May our lives draw others to Your saving love. **Amen.**



for your generous support

GREENLOUGH PARISH. Mass Schedule/Notices: 17 - 23 August 2026**Twentieth Sunday in Ordinary Time****GREENLOUGH**

Tuesday 18 August: 9.30am Mass; 7.30pm: Rosary
Thursday 20 August: 9.00am - 5.00pm Adoration
Friday 21 August: 9.30am Mass

Twenty First Sunday in Ordinary Time

Saturday 22 August: 5.30pm (*Streamed to Bellaghy*)
Anniversary Mass for Kelly Maria McGoldrick
Month's Mind Mass for Philomena (Mena) Loughlin

Sunday 23 August: 11.00am (*Streamed from Bellaghy*)

BELLAGHY

Wednesday 19 August: 9.30am
Friday 21 August: Adoration 10am - 8pm; Rosary at 7.30pm
Saturday 22 August: 5.30pm (*Streamed from Greenlough*)
Sunday 23 August: 11.00am (*Streamed to Greenlough*)

BALLYSCULLION

Sunday 23 August: 9.45am

Deaths: We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of Kyle Johnston, Toomebridge and Bridget Murphy, Bellaghy, who died recently.

Anniversaries: Mary Toner, Felix Gribbon, Eoin Og McErlean, Philip Clarke, Annie Mary Kearney, John McLaughlin, Bridget McLaughlin, Mick Kearney, Rose Henry, Sarah Murphy, Maria Goretti Boyle.

Vocations: That the men called to priesthood will "...have a care for justice [and] act with integrity..." as they preach the message of God's salvation for everyone, the Good News that the Church is "...a house of prayer for all the peoples."

Greenlough Collections: 9/8/2026. Weekly/Monthly/Cash - £911.20.

St Joseph Men's Camino: *Every Camino changes us in ways we don't expect, every man needs one.* Join men from across Ireland on **Saturday 12 September** for a 25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda. The day includes Mass, Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch and dinner, with after-dinner speaker **Fr. Mark Quinn**. Open to men aged 18+. Cost: €65 (student €55). Registration, accommodation and details: www.dominicans.ie/events. Enquiries: op.evangelisation@gmail.com.

Marriage Enrichment Weekend: Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential Weekend from Friday 2 to Sunday 4 October 2026 at the Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare. Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage. Visit: www.marriageencounter.ie

No Printed Newsletter until the end of August: Please send Notices & Anniversaries in writing or via email to the parish office by 10.00am on Wednesday or leave into the Sacristy before Mass on Saturday night.

Greenlough Parish Office is closed but you can contact us via phone: 028 2582 1190.
 Email: greenloughparish@gmail.com or via Facebook.

OUR LADY OF MONTLIGEON PRAYER GROUP- praying for all the souls in Purgatory meets in Termonbacca, on the last Wednesday each month at 12:30pm. Also in St Joseph's Church Galliagh every Monday after 11am Mass.

RACHEL'S VINEYARD: Have you been hurt by abortion? Tel Michelle 07871765181.

GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS: Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 028 7135 1329.

Accord Derry Marriage Preparation Workshops September 25th/26th November 20th/21st 2026 These courses are now online for booking at www.accordni.com

'Embrace the Grace' Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August 2026 - Legion of Mary: 'Embrace the Grace' is a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. It will be a chance to build faith in friendship with young adults from across the country. This event takes place on Saturday 30 August from 9.30am to 6.00pm with a social afterwards. Tickets cost €20 and can be booked on the eventbrite website by looking up 'Embrace the Grace'. Any queries can be directed towards deusetpatria@gmail.com.

MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND: Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential Weekend from Friday 2 to Sunday 4 October 2026 at the Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare. Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage. Visit www.marriageencounter.ie

SAFEGUARDING Any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children and Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

Northern Ireland emergency services PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland) 101 Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker) Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust 028 9442 4459 Regional Emergency Social Work Services 0800 1979 99

PRIVACY NOTICE The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A privacy notice is available on the Parish Website Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in Holy Family Church are available on line. Parishioners should note that the first 2 rows of seats are visible on line.

HOLY FAMILY CHURCH



Sun 16th August

Vol. 44 No 33

MASSES

Saturday Vigil 6.00pm

Sunday 9.30am, 11.00am, 12.30pm

Mon, Wed, Fri, Sat 10.00am Tues and Thurs 7.15pm

CONFESSIONS

Saturdays from 10.30am-11.30am & 5.15pm-5.50pm

Tues, Thurs 6.45pm – 7.10pm

Divine Mercy 3pm Monday– Friday

BAPTISMS

Saturday at 4.30pm

MARRIAGES

Three months notice and marriage preparation necessary

PAROCHIAL HOUSE

71267070

1 Aileach Road Ballymagroarty BT48 0AZ

Email: office@holyfamily-parish.com

Website: www.holyfamily-parish.com

Webcam: Click on website and follow the links

Parish Office 9.45am-1.45pm Mon– Fri

Parish Priest:
Fr Joseph Gormley

Curate
Fr Kevin Mulhern

EVEN A CRUMB OF MERCY IS ENOUGH

Matthew 15:21–28 tells of the Canaanite woman who begs Jesus to heal her daughter. At first, Jesus seems silent and distant. Even the disciples want her sent away. Yet she refuses to leave. Her prayer is simple and urgent: “Lord, help me.”

When Jesus speaks about the children’s bread not being thrown to the house-dogs, she answers with remarkable humility and trust: “Even house-dogs can eat the scraps that fall from their master’s table.” She does not insist that she deserves anything. She simply believes that even the smallest crumb of God’s mercy is enough to transform her daughter’s life.

Jesus responds: “Woman, you have great faith. Let your wish be granted.” This Gospel teaches us that God’s silence is not necessarily God’s absence. Sometimes prayer appears unanswered, but faith continues to call upon him. The woman moves through silence, apparent rejection and humiliation without surrendering her trust.

She also crosses every boundary: she is a woman, a foreigner and an outsider. Yet Jesus reveals that faith—not race, status or belonging—opens the heart to God’s saving mercy.

A prayer for the week

“Lord, help me. Even a crumb of your mercy is enough.”

SYMPATHY We offer our sympathy to the family of Jim McGarigle, Donal Casey Court who died during the week. May he rest in peace

BAPTISMS Our Parish family welcomes: Caoili O’Neill , Barleyfields Ahlora-Dia Monica O’Donnell, Barr’s Lane

ANNIVERSARIES We pray for those whose anniversaries occur at this time Mickey Gill, Charlie Lynch, Jackie Coyle, Mona Leonard, Mickey Quigley, Kieran Doherty, Esther McElhinney, Edward Callaghan, Jim McLaughlin.

SUNDAY COLLECTION 9th August £2131.16 Standing Orders £400 and €200.23 Thank you for your generosity

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS TO THE DIOCESAN PRIESTHOOD That the men called to priesthood will "...have a care for justice [and] act with integrity..." as they preach the message of God's salvation for everyone, the Good News that the Church is "...a house of prayer for all the peoples

LEGION OF MARY meets on Wednesday evenings at 5.45pm. Anyone willing to do Our Lady’s work is asked to call Patricia on 02871417867

ROSARY ON THE COAST. Rosary on the Coast will be at 3pm today Sunday at Benone We will pray for unborn children. Tel 077303 30028

THE NATIONAL NOVENA TO OUR LADY OF KNOCK takes place at Knock Shrine from Thursday 13 to Friday 21 August 2026. Novena ceremonies will be celebrated daily at 3.00pm and 8.00pm, with workshops and guided prayer sessions also taking place throughout the nine days. This year’s theme is **“Sheltered in God’s Love.** See the full programme at: <https://www.knockshrine.ie/national-novena-2026-guest-speakers-and-programme/>

JOB OPPORTUNITY, DERRY DIOCESAN TRUST: Administrative & Financial Officer (18 hours per week), Waterside Parish, Parochial House, 32 Chapel Road, Derry. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hr - £13.50 per hr. For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or tel 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop’s House, St Eugene’s Cathedral, or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12 noon Monday 24 August

ST JOSEPH MEN'S CAMINO *Every Camino changes us in ways we don't expect, every man needs one.* Join men from across Ireland on **Saturday 12th September** for a 25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda. The day includes Mass, Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch and dinner, with after-dinner speaker **Fr. Mark Quinn.** Open to men aged 18+. Cost: €65 (student € 55). Registration, accomodation and details: www.dominicans.ie/events. Enquiries: op.evangelisation@gmail.com.

ANAM CARA Bereavement Information Evening especially dedicated to supporting surviving siblings [Tuesday 15 September at 7pm.](#)

As part of our commitment to supporting everyone following the death of a child, we are exploring opportunities to further support the entire family. This event is the first, hopefully of many, of that commitment. This event is open to all parents whose child or children have died, regardless of the age of their child, circumstances of their death, or time since bereavement. We are also opening this Bereavement Information Evening to bereaved adult siblings over 18.

ST JOSEPH’S BOYS SCHOOL YEAR GROUP INDUCTION DAYS
8.40am—12noon Year 12 and 14 Monday 24th August
Years 9, 10, 11—Wednesday 26th Year 8 and 13 Friday 28th Aug.
All classes will attend Tuesday 1st September

Parish of Kilrea & Desertohill

Rev. Christopher McDermott
Parish Secretary: Mrs Kim Convery



Twentieth Sunday of The Year

16th August 2026

www.parishofkilrea.com

E-mail: parishofkilrea@btinternet.com

Facebook: *Parish of Kilrea & Desertohill*

Telephone: 028 29540343

Errigal: 028 29558251

Vigil Mass (Sat) 7pm at Saint Anne's Oratory – Sunday 10am at Drumagarner – Sunday 12noon at Craigavole

Weekday Masses

No Weekday Masses during week beginning
17th & 24th August.

Weekend Masses at usual times.

Weekday schedule resumes Monday 31st Aug.

In Remembrance of

Julia McAteer, Mick Kearney, James O'Brien,
Rev Thomas Rodgers, Sean Mullan, Denis
McWilliams, Roddy O'Kane, Frank Bradley,
Seamus Harkin, Annie Gribben, Anne
Quigley, Lizzie O'Kane and Patrick Tohill.
whose anniversaries occur at this time.

Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord.

Congratulations to

Micheala McErlean & Tomás Clarke



whose marriage was celebrated recently.
We wish them well for their future together!

Kilrea GAC News

Lottery result 06th August: 10, 20, 22, 23.

No Winner £3,750

£25 – Declan McAlary (Lisgorgan)

£25 – Mickey Dallat

Next Jackpot is £3,800.

Tickets on Klubfunder.

Last week's collection amounted to £2,035.

Thank You

Months Mind Mass for **Ernie Gorham** on
Sunday 23rd August 2026 at 11.30am in St
Malachy's Church Coleraine.

Vocations Prayer: That the men called to priesthood
will "...have a care for justice [and] act with integrity..."
as they preach the message of God's salvation for
everyone, the Good News that the Church is "...a house
of prayer for all the peoples." Fr Pat O'Hagan

Safeguarding Notice: Should you have any concerns
regarding the safeguarding of children or vulnerable
people within the church, please contact Marie O'Kane,
the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on
07596500793 or e-mail dlp@derrydiocese.org. PSNI Tel
101. Northern HSCT Gateway Services on 028 9442 4459.
Emergency Social Work Services on: 0800 1979 995.

Adult Ceili Dancing every Wednesday at 7pm
in The Marian Hall Kilrea
New members welcome. No previous
experience required, Fun, Fitness & Friendship.
No need to book, £5 per week.

The Net Newspaper: As always, it features a wide
variety of news, interesting and inspiring interviews,
articles, and photos from parishes across the diocese.
You can read the Diocesan newspaper on-line at. or a
paper copy is available at the back of the church.
Donations welcome.

Readers for 22nd Aug/ 23rd Aug

7pm:
Margaret McAllister
10am:
Liz McWilliams
12noon:
Anne O'Connell

Eucharistic Adoration

Monday Exposition of
the Blessed Sacrament
will pause during July &
August for the summer
break.
Weekly adoration
resumes on Monday 7th
September.

Mass Times
Sundays:
Vigil: 6.00pm
Morning:
9am & 11am

Weekdays:
Mon - Fri:
9.15am

Baptisms
Sundays
11.45am

Telephone
No's
Fr. Graham
028 7964 2458

Parish Office:
028 7964 2458

SVP Helpline
07596971627

St. Brigid's PS.
028 7964 2014

Lavey Early
Years
028 7964 5464

Neighbouring
Parishes

Maghera
Fr. Doherty
028 7964 2496

Kilrea
Fr. McDermott
028 2954 0343

Lavey Parish St. Vincent de Paul

School holidays can be stressful for many families, especially in these times of rising household costs. Back-to-school expenses can also add to the pressure on families. If you feel we can be of assistance in such situations, please contact us on our helpline **07596971627** and leave a message. Someone will get back to you in confidence.



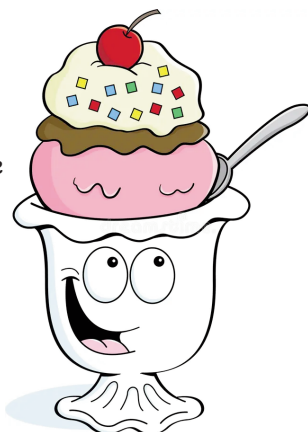
ICE-CREAM SUNDAY

*Saturday 5th &
 Sunday 6th September*

*All Weekend Masses will be
 celebrated in
 Lavey/Termoneeny Centre.*

*All Proceeds in aid of
 Parish Funds.*

All Welcome!



Parish Details

There will be **NO**
NEWSLETTER next weekend.

The Parish Office
 will be **CLOSED** from
Wednesday 19th and
REOPENING on Tuesday
24th August

Thank-You



Lavey Parish

Tel: (028) 7964 2458

E-Mail: laveyparish@derrydiocese.org

Web: www.laveyparish.com



Mercy to every person **“Lord”**, the woman said, **“help me.”** Human life is too big and too complex for any of us to live it on our own. We have all kinds of people and relationships to help us to wholeness. The most important one of all has to be the presence of Christ with us. The intimate relationships of marriage and family life, for example, change so often and so deeply that we cannot manage them on our own. Christ is with us to help us see the opportunities for ever greater loving and to give us the strength to grow in our love. Relationships within the faith community are also so complex that we cannot possibly build our unity with one another except through the power of Christ. When we depend on our own efforts, we set very low limits and settle for mediocrity. When we call on the power of Christ, and live by his power, we are set free to reach for the stars.

Father Johnny Doherty, C.Ss.R.



Monday 17th August **9.15 am Mass**
 Wednesday 19th August **9.15 am Mass**
 Thursday 20th August **9.15 am Mass**
 Friday 21st August **9.15 am Mass**

Adoration will begin *after morning Mass*
 and conclude at **5.00 pm.**

21st Sunday in Ordinary Time

Saturday 22nd August **5:15 pm - 5:45 pm - Confessions**
6:00 pm Mass

Sunday 23rd August **9:00 pm Mass**
11:00 am Mass

Monday 24th August **9.15 am Mass**
 Wednesday 26th August **9.15 am Mass**
 Thursday 27th August **9.15 am Mass**
 Friday 28th August **9.15 am Mass**

Adoration will begin *after morning Mass*
 and conclude at **5.00 pm.**

22nd Sunday in Ordinary Time

Saturday 29th August **5:15 pm - 5:45 pm - Confessions**
6:00 pm Mass

Sunday 30th August **9:00 pm Mass**
11:00 am Mass

Sunday 16th August - 20th Sunday in Ordinary Time

We look forward to welcoming the parishioners from the Three Patrons, Derry, to our church this Tuesday evening. The Three Patrons are undertaking a Marian pilgrimage, visiting the parishes of Ardmore, Feeny, Dungiven, Maghera, and Lavey.



The Famine Bell

We have recently acquired, through the good auspices of the Late Father Liam Donnelly, a very old church bell. This bell was cast during the famine years.

It is hoped to place the bell in the old cemetery near the old church ruin in memory of the victims of the Great Famine, many of whom are buried here. It is also a memorial to all victims of conflict in the years since the building of the Church in 1803.

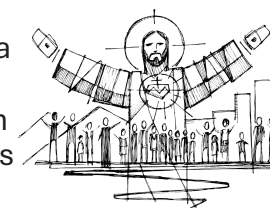
The bell also reminds us that the law of the land forbade Church bells when the old church was built. This was one of the Penal Laws.

Going further back, it also links us to the Great St. Patrick's Bell, which was for many years concealed in Mayogall for safety.



Prayer for Vocations

That the men called to priesthood will "...have a care for justice [and] act with integrity.." as they preach the message of God's salvation for everyone, the Good News that the Church is "...a house of prayer for all the peoples."



Parish Collections: Sunday 9th August

Weekly: **£874.40**
 Building: **£946.70**
 Loose Coin: **£500.14**

Thank you for your continued support!



**Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick
Eighteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A – 2nd August 2026**

Parish Clergy

Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215

Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)

Email: leckpatrickparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.leckpatrickparish.com

Email: strabaneparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.camusparish.com

Email: clonleighparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.clonleighparish.com

Thoughts on the Gospel (Matthew 14:13-21)

The miracle of the loaves and fishes began with **compassion**. Jesus first noticed the crowd's pain before providing for their hunger. In our busy lives, God invites us to see those who are lonely, discouraged, or forgotten. Even small acts of kindness can become someone's miracle.

The disciples focused on what they lacked, yet Jesus asked them to offer what they *did* have. God rarely asks for what we do not possess. When we offer our time, talents, and resources — however small — He multiplies them in ways we cannot imagine.

Before the food was shared, Jesus surrendered everything to the Father. We too carry burdens that feel heavy, but surrender is not giving up; it is trusting God with our limitations. What seems insufficient to us becomes more than enough in His hands. The abundance left over reminds us that God's blessings are meant to flow *through* us. When we share generously, encourage others, and forgive freely, His grace continues to multiply.

***Lord, fill us with compassion, use what little we offer, and multiply it for Your glory.
Teach us to trust You and to share Your blessings generously. Amen.***

Monthly Mass in Honour of St Pio will be celebrated on Wednesday 5th August at 7.00 pm in Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane. We ask God's blessing on all through the intercession of St Pio. Everyone welcome.

Due to the Current Holiday Period, we wish to notify parishioners that there will be no newsletter until 22nd/23rd August. Apologies for any inconvenience. The office will be open as follows for the following two weeks: 10 am - 2 pm, Monday - Friday. Normal hours will resume on Monday 17th August.

The Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary

Saturday 15th August is the Feast of the Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary and is a holy day of obligation. On this feast, we recall Mary's role in the life of Jesus and in salvation. Mass times for the holy day are as follows:

Vigil Mass on Friday 14th August at 6.30 pm in Immaculate Conception Church

Mass on Saturday 15th August at 8.30 am in Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

Mass on Saturday 15th August at 10.00 am in St Patrick's Church, Murlog.

Masses at the usual times on the evening of Saturday 15th & Sunday 16th August.

Prayer at Time of Exam Results

Dear Lord, in this moment of uncertainty, I seek Your peace and guidance.
Help me to accept the results of my efforts with grace, whether they meet
my hopes or not. Grant me the strength to learn and grow from this experience,
trusting in Your plan for my life. May I find comfort in Your love and wisdom.
May Your peace fill my heart as I walk forward in faith. Amen.

Requiescant in Pace We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of
Harry Mullen, Victoria Rd, Strabane; Bernie Greene, Tipperary.

Anniversaries Tony Boggs, Joseph Colhoun, Willie Curran, May Doherty,
Johnny Forbes, Charlie Gallagher, Johnny Gallagher, Kevin Gallagher, Mary Gallagher,
Nellie Gallagher, David Kennedy, Susan Lafferty, Anne Maguire, Bernard McDermott,
Laurence McDermott, Emmett McGhee, Thomas McGranaghan, James O'Neill,
Martin Stevenson, Vincent Sweeney, James McDermott (60th anniversary),
Margaret McCay, Anna Morgan. May they rest in peace.

9.45am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Thank You for your generosity to last week's collections:

Leckpatrick: £1,372.61;

Clonleigh: €1,925.66;

Camus: £1,420.06.

Thanks to those who pay by standing order.

Readings for Sunday 9th August:

1st Reading: First Kings 19: 9a, 11-13a

Psalm: 85: 9, 10, 11-12, 13-14

2nd Reading: Romans 9: 1-5

Gospel: Matthew 14: 22-33

Readings 15th August (Feast of the Assumption):

1st Reading: Revelation 11: 19a; 12: 1-6a, 10ab

Psalm: 45: 10, 11, 12, 16

2nd Reading: 1st Corinthians 15: 20-27;

Gospel: Luke 1: 39-56

Readings for Sunday 16th August:

1st Reading: Isaiah 56: 1, 6-7

Psalm: 67: 2-3, 5, 6, 8

2nd Reading: Romans 11: 13-15, 29-32

Gospel: Matthew 15: 21-28

Readings for Sunday 23rd August:

1st Reading: Isaiah 22: 19-23

Psalm: 137: 1-3, 6, 8

2nd Reading: Romans 11: 33-36

Gospel: Matthew 16: 13-20

Saints of The Coming Week:

Tuesday: St John Vianney, priest;

Wed: The Dedication of the Basilica of St Mary Major in Rome;

Thurs: The Transfiguration of the Lord;

Fri: St Cajetan, priest; St Sixtus II, pope, & companions, martyrs;

Sat: St Dominic, priest

Embrace the Grace Legion of Mary Young Adult (18-40) Catholic Conference takes place on Sat 29th August from 9.30 am - 6 pm at De Montfort House, Morning Star Ave, Dublin, D07 VA03. Tickets from www.eventbrite. Search Embrace the Grace.

Pope's Prayer Intention for August *For evangelisation in the city*

Let us pray that in large cities often marked by anonymity and loneliness we find new ways to proclaim the Gospel, discovering creative paths to build community.

Rosary on the Coast takes place today (Sunday) at 3.00 pm at Lisfannon Beach, praying for peace, Ireland and our unborn children. Everyone welcome.

Give Blood, Save Lives NI Blood Transfusion Service will collect blood donations at Lisneal College, 70 Crescent Link, Derry, BT47 5FQ on 4th August from 1230 pm - 4.00 pm & 5.00 pm - 7.30 pm. Please freecall 08085534653 to book.

Lough Derg Annual Fundraising Draw to ensure Station Island remains open for future generations. Single ticket: €10. Book of 6: €50. Buy a full book and you're entered into a sellers' draw. Return a complete book for Early Bird draws on 28/8/26. Tickets from www.loughderg.org/store/c3/annualdraw or +353 (0) 719861518 or info@loughderg.org Prizes: 1st: €10,000, 2nd: €5,000, 3rd: €2,000, 4th: €1,500, 5th: €1,000, 6th: €500. Draw date: 23rd October 2026.

Job Opportunity Derry Diocesan Trust invites applications for the post of Administrative & Financial Officer at Clonmany Parish. 9 hours pw. For application pack, please contact Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, BT48 9AP, 02871262302 or recruitment@derrydiocese.org Closing date: 11th August 2026.

Franciscan Friary, Rossnowlagh Monthly Healing Service today (Sunday). Rosary at 2.45 pm followed by Mass / Healing Service at 3 pm. Confessions 2 - 5 pm.

ACCORD Derry Marriage Preparation Courses available at www.accordni.com

Monthly Mass in Memory of Sr Clare Crockett will be celebrated on Sunday 9th August at 7 pm in Carmelite Retreat Centre, Termonbacca, Derry.

Pray for Vocations We pray for men called to priesthood. Like Jesus in today's gospel, may they never turn away from the poor, hungry, most vulnerable or those in need, but always reflect the love of Christ as they nourish and strengthen them with the Word of God. Visit <https://derryvocations.org>

A Day of Healing & Prayer in the House of Prayer, Clonfert with Eddie Stone on Sat 15th August. A bus leaves Letterkenny, collecting people in Ballybofey and Donegal Town. A priest will accompany the group. Please contact 0863936547.

Sharing the Good News Visit <https://theway.ie/ezine-2/> for the weekly ezine.

Sean Davis 4 Day Outdoor Summer Fun Soccer Academy takes place at Templemore Sports Complex, Derry from 4th - 7th August. Boys and girls aged 5 - 18 welcome. Times: 10 am - 3 pm. Please contact Sean on 07787791880.

Youth 2000 Festival | 13th–16th August Calling all young people (16 - 35). Join us in Newbridge College, Kildare. Free buses. All meals included. Inspiring talks, workshops, Mass, music, prayer, and plenty of opportunities to chill out and meet other young Catholics. Visit youth2000.ie or follow @Youth2000Ireland

Family Carers Ireland are running 1:1 support clinics remotely every Tuesday in August for carers, offering you a space and time to talk over the phone in the comfort of your own home. Contact 0868363842 or Donegalcs@familycarers.ie

Lough Derg As the **3 Day Pilgrimage** season draws to a close soon (final day to start is 13th August), our **Day Retreats** recommence on August 18, 22, 23, 29 & 31 and September 5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19, 20. Take time away from the busyness of life for a day of guided prayer, quiet reflection and spiritual renewal in the peaceful surroundings of Lough Derg. Booking essential. Please visit www.loughderg.org

Mary's Meals Annual Step by Step Walk takes place on Sunday 9th August at 12 noon from Sainsbury's car park, Strand Rd, Derry, walking around the Foyle Bridge & Peace Bridge. All welcome, even for a mile or two. Mary's Meals currently feeds over 3 million children a daily school meal across 16 countries. For further details / to register, please visit www.marysmeals.org.uk/step or contact Caoimhe on 07394564065. Please keep all our walkers in your prayers.

Donegal Pro Life Annual Church Gate Collection takes place on Saturday 15th / Sunday 16th August countywide. If you can help in taking up a collection, it would be appreciated. Please contact Margaret on 00353892469599. Míle buíochas.

The Monthly Pro Life Witness / Gathering takes place at the roundabout at Letterkenny Hospital on Friday 7th August from 1 pm - 2 pm. All welcome.

The Contemplative Prayer Group meets on Mondays at 8 pm in the Prayer Room in the Parochial House, Barrack St. All welcome.

Termonbacca Derry Anam Óg Summer Scheme for those aged 8 - 14 takes place from 3rd - 7th August from 12 - 4 pm daily. Faith, friendship, arts and crafts, adventures, games and prayer. Please email termonbaccaderry@ocd.ie

Walk in Our Patron Saint's Footsteps St Patrick's Way Pilgrim Walk, Downpatrick with guides Martina Purdy & Elaine Kelly on **8th August 9 am - 3 pm** Cost (£55). Tel 028 44619000. Visit www.saintpatrickcentre.com

Reflections Through Poetry book by Fr John P Forbes available in Pastoral Office. Cost: £10. Proceeds to Children in Crossfire and Cause for Sr Clare's Canonisation.

Parish Bingo & Lucky Four A warm welcome to all to St Pat's Hall every Thursday at 8 pm. Come along for some fun, excitement and slight competition.

Strabane / Leckpatrick Draw July 2026

Prize	Winner	Promoter
£2,000	Philomena & Bosco Gallagher	Siobhan McDevitt
£1,000	Pat Gallagher	Sadie Kerlin
£500	Fr Paul Farren	Fr Michael
£500	Conal Doherty	Colette McKane
£250	Paddy Quinn	Fr Michael
£250	Brian Devine	Gabrielle Dooher
£100	Finola Kerr	Nuala Kerr
£100	Laura Burke	Paul Mullen
£100	Steven Casey	Paul Mullen
£100	Mary Barrett	Patsy Barrett
£100	Sarah McMichael	Ann McCrory

Congratulations to all the winners. Thank you for your support.

Weekend Mass Schedule

Immaculate Conception: Saturday Vigil: **4.30 pm**; Sunday: **11.00 am**

Sacred Heart, Derry Road: Sunday: **12.15 pm**

St Patrick's, Clonleigh: Saturday Vigil: **6.30 pm**; Sunday: **9.45 am**

St Joseph's, Glenmornan: Sunday: **8.30 am** (2nd August - alternate Sundays - 16th August)

St Mary's, Cloughcor: Sunday: **8.30 am** (9th August - alternate Sundays - 23rd August)

Weekday Mass Schedule

Monday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Tuesday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Wednesday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

(followed by **Eucharistic Adoration** until 5.30 pm).

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Thursday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Friday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Weddings Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months' notice required.

Baptisms: Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

The Parish Pastoral Area Office, 27 Butcher St, Strabane covers all 3 parishes.

Office hours: Monday – Thursday: 9.30 am - 4.30 pm; Friday: 9.30 am - 12.30 pm.

Please feel free to call in or phone on 028 7188 2215.

Reminder that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays.

A Small Collection of Candles is available for purchase at the Pastoral Office.

A gentle reminder that we can only accept cash or cheque payments. Thank you.

Safeguarding (Northern Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Adult at risk of harm or Adult in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact PSNI on 101, Western HSCT Children's Gateway Services on 028 71 314090, WHSCT Adult Gateway Services on 028 71 611366 or the Regional Emergency Social Work Service on 028 95 049999.

Safeguarding (Republic of Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +44 7596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact Garda Síochána Buncrana on 074 93 20540, Garda Síochána Letterkenny on 074 91 67100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency on 074 91 02233 or HSC Adult Safeguarding, Donegal on 071 983 4660.

Fr. Patrick Doherty 79642496 / Fr. Kieran O'Doherty 79642359
 Sacristans: Glen 79643131/Maghera 79643061 Web Cam www.mcnmedia.live
 Baptisms: 79642983(Notification by Thursday) Pastoral Centre:79642983
 Pilgrim Statue: 79642983 / St Vincent de Paul Helpline: 07752111032
 PARISH FACEBOOK PAGE – www.facebook.com/magheraparish

It's a useful way to stay up to date with all our parish events. Please hit the 'Follow' button and we would be grateful if you could like and share our posts.

Sunday:	St Patrick's	9.30am
	St Mary's	Vigil 6.30am and Sunday 11.30am
		Wednesday 7.30pm and Friday 10.00am
Daily Mass	St Patrick's	Monday to Thursday 9.30am
		Friday 7.30pm (Mass for all deceased)
		Daily Rosary at 9.10am

That those who may be anxious or worried about feeling called to priesthood will trust the Lord and hear the One who is "gentle and humble in heart" promising them rest and the peace that comes from knowing He is with them carrying their burdens alongside them.

Rev. Pat O'Hagan

HOLY FACE OF JESUS – Prayers every Tuesday after 9.30am Mass and Divine Mercy.

The 9.30am Mass in Glen Church on Thursday 16 July will be offered for all deceased DDS members.

IRISH MASS AT GRANAGHAN MASS ROCK – on Tues 7 July at 7pm. Join us to celebrate Mass through Irish. Light refreshments will be served. Parking at adjacent field.

MATT TALBOT PRAYER SOCIETY MONTHLY MASS will take place in St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, tomorrow, Monday 6 July at 7.30pm. The Mass is offered for enrolled members, all those dealing with addiction and their families. Everyone is welcome to attend. Free Spiritual Protection Packs will be available after Mass. These are for the protection of families and homes from drugs.

DIOCESE OF DERRY – LOUGH DERG PILGRIMAGE 2026: The Three-Day Pilgrimage will take place from Fri 24 to Sun 26 July. Lough Derg welcomes people seeking prayer, peace, reflection and renewal, offering an opportunity to step away from the pace of daily life and make space for God. For those availing of the bus transport (from St Eugene's Cathedral via Strabane and Lifford) the cost is £95/110Euros, including bus transport. Booking form and full details are available at derrydiocese.org/lough-Derg.

Fr. MIKE SCHMITZ PARABLES TOUR FOR YOUNG PEOPLE -20th JULY-DUBLIN: Derry Youth Ministry are inviting young people aged 16+ to join them for the Fr. Mike Schmitz Parables Tour taking place on 20 July 2026 in the National Stadium, Dublin. Fr. Mike is an American priest and digital evangelist, who will present the message of the Gospel in a novel, energetic and engaging style that speaks into young people's lives today. There will be a special Mass for youth attending from all over Ireland to begin the evening celebrations. Cost is £45 for ticket and transport. Bus departs Derry at 12Noon, with pick-ups in Strabane and Omagh. To secure your place or for more information contact bethany.doherty@derrydiocese.org or call 028 71264087.

ENVELOPE COLLECTION -Thank you for last week's envelope collections of £3,176.00. We appreciate your support to the church and for bringing your envelopes and donations church and pastoral centre. May your generosity be rewarded. Anyone wishing to donate to Maghera parish may do so by visiting website: magheraparishderry.com and using donate button.

ROARY ON THE COAST – today (Sunday) 5 July at 3pm at Lisfannon Beach

ATU St Angela's is inviting applications for the following programme beginning Autumn 2026: **Part-Time Certificate in Religious Education for Primary School**, with Online Delivery. The programme is open to: Qualified primary school teachers: Qualified post-primary school teachers who wish to transfer to primary school teaching. Parents, sacramental preparation teams and parish catechists who have a specific interest in the area of primary religious education may also apply. Closing date for Applications is Friday 14 August 2026. For further information contact: Mary Kearns, Senior Administrator, Education Department, ATU St Angelas, Lough Gill, Sligo. mail: mary.kearns@atu.ie or visit Website: www.atu.ie

SENIORS TUESDAY CLUB –on Tuesdays in Yough Club at 1030am.

All welcome! There will no Tuesday Club on 14th, 21st and 28 July. Re-opens- Tues 4 August.

GLEN GAA Website www.wattvgrahamsac.com Lotto Numbers 45:43:34:29: No winner. Next week £6,000. One £50 winner – Damian McElroy. Flyover next week £16,100 in 45 Nos or less.

ALLAGHLOON HALL: BINGO-Sunday night 7.30pm. Jackpot £500 in 45 numbers.

THIRD WORLD SHOP 24/6/26 - Since the last notice in the bulletin, £12,500 has been gratefully received by the following. The Columban Missionaries were so thankful for £2,000 to help fund a higher Education Centre where Fr. Neil Magill worked in Myanmar. Sr. Kay O'Neill got £1,500 for Little Assisi School Project which they are planning to open later this year. Fr. Danny Monaghan and his brother Fr. Mark at home from a very difficult Mission caring for the poor in slums in Lagos Nigeria got £1,500 each. Sr. Brigid Quinn retired but still supports a hospital and school in a very poor area in Cameroon got £1,000. Fr. Brian O'Kane also retired gets several requests from Zambia for help. He got £1,000. Anne and Brian Holloway on pilgrimage got £1,000 to help the poor in Medjugorje. Oblates of Mary Immaculate are celebrating 200 years of Missionary work. They got £1,500 to help some of the poorest in many parts of the world. Fr. Martin Mulholland was so grateful for £1,500 which he used to support schools, orphanages and the needy and vulnerable in areas he is familiar with. We will also be supporting other Missionaries who come home for summer. This would not be possible without your great support for the shop and St Joseph's Shrine. Your donations of good saleable clothes etc. and our faithful customers are so appreciated by all.

PILGRIMAGE TO FATIMA: - Flying direct from Belfast. 7 nights F/B -Avenida Hotel – 14/21 August. Spiritual Director: Fr. Andrew McMahon PP. Convenient Flight times – Cost: £845pp. For further details contact Joe 07776425631.

MEDIJUGORJE TRIPS – with local group in 2026 through Marian Pilgrimages. Wed 29 July – Wed 4 August. Be in Medjugorje for the Youth Festival(all ages welcome!) £705 including discount. Or choose quieter time of the year – Wed 28 Oct – Wed 4 Nov. All Saints Day and All souls Day in Medjugorje - £710 including discount. 0759600793 or email: dip@derrydiocese.org

AN CARN – Get creative this Spring with workshops at An Carn!

15th Sunday in Ordinary Time (Year A)

12 July 2026

The Soil of Our Lives

This Sunday Jesus tells us the parable of the sower. It is one of the most familiar stories in the Gospels. A farmer scatters seed. Some falls on the path, some on rocky ground, some among thorns, and some on rich soil. Only the rich soil produces a harvest.

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I'm in Fatima with Fr Stephen Baxter (our newly ordained) and 60 others from our Parishes and others in Fatima. Please be assured of our prayers at all our Masses, Rosaries and Processions for you all and your intentions, and I ask for yours for us as well. Thanks to Fr Michael Canny PP, Fr Patrick Lagan CC and Fr Joshy Parokkaran CC from Waterside for providing cover while I'm away.

We welcome into God's Family through the Sacrament of Baptism:

Lottie Kimberley Jowett

Remy Petroosbabakhan

May they Rest in Peace

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Tommy Finlay, Harry McCrossan, Anne McCay

Magdalene Curry, Molly McDaid, David Coyle

Deirdre Drumm Pearce, Dessie Drumm, Grace Drumm

Noel Brennan, Joe McNulty, Alice Alexander

Robert Brennan, George Fitzpatrick, Francis Moss

Margaret Quigley, Packie Duncan, Frank McElwee

Michael McDaid, Ann McShane, Patrick Early

George Early, Sarah Early, George Devenney

David McDaid, Marie Henderson

Announcements

Last week’s collections amounted to: **Melmount:** £3373.00; **Sion Mills:** £1465.00. Thank you. Those who pay to the weekly collection or any special collections, including Priest’s Collection by cheque are asked that all cheques should be made payable to ‘*Melmount Parish*’ or ‘*Sion Mills Parish*’ depending on the Parish. This is a banking requirement. *Parishioners can still leave their contributions in the Parish Office. If the Office is closed, please use the letterbox.*

Parish Bulletin This is the last bulletin until September.

Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament will take place in St. Mary's, Melmount tomorrow, Monday 13 July after 10.00am Mass until 6.30pm.

Vocations We pray for the men called to serve the Church as priests of our diocese, that their hearts will be the fertile soil Jesus needs to receive the seed which is His Word, and that they will spread His Word, His Good News, by their preaching and by the example of their lives.

Adoration Everyday The Blessed Sacrament can be adored in the Adoration Room, St. Theresa's, Sion Mills anytime while the church is open.

Baptism Dates Melmount

July: Sunday 19; Saturday 25; Sunday 26.

August: Saturday 8; Saturday 29.

September: Saturday 5; Sunday 13; Saturday 19.

October: Sunday 4; Saturday 10; Saturday 17; Saturday 24.

November: Sunday 8; Saturday 14; Saturday 21; Saturday 28.

Baptisms will be at 3.30pm on a Saturday and 12.45pm on a Sunday.

To book a Baptism contact the Parish Office on 71383777 during office hours.

Accord Marriage Preparation Courses (Pre-Marriage Courses) will take place in September 25/26 and November 20/21. All courses are now online for booking at

Www.Accordni.Com

Please Note: These courses are in person and not online courses.

Accord Derry will NOT be facilitating courses during October or December.

Safeguarding Notice If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the church please contact Marie O’Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email@

Dlp@Derrydiocese.Org

. *Northern Ireland emergency services: PSNI on 101; Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 71314090 and ask for the Duty Social Worker. Regional Emergency Social Work Services 0800 1979 995.*

The Parish Draws for July and August took place on Wednesday 8 July. The winners are as follows:

July Draw

£500: 1027 Genevieve O'Neill – *Genevieve O'Neill*

£250: 1350 Concepta McGarrigle – *Ann Donaghey*

£250: 1708 Thomas Moore – *Teresa Quigg*

£250: 1338 Marianne Patton – *Carol-ann Stewart*

£150: 1995 Tammy McNulty – *Irene Callan*

£150: 1304 Ina O'Neill – *Sheelagh McKelvey*

£150: 1719 Christine McHugh – *Teresa Quigg*

£100: 1243 Bronagh Lynch – *Declan Duffy*

£100: 1669 Declan McColgan – *Madeleine McColgan*

£100: 1702 Terrie Logue - *Genevieve O'Neill*

August Draw

£500: 1756 Vincent McCarron – *Katrina Houston*

£250: 1626 Anne Neeson – *Madeleine McColgan*

£250: 1379 Gary McNicholl – *Sheelagh McKelvey*

£250: 1862 Emma Lynch – *Elizabeth O'Hare*

£150: 1825 Susan McGuinness – *John Donohoe*

£150: 1684 Teresa Boggs – *Katrina Houston*

£150: 1380 Bridget McCrory – *Sheelagh McKelvey*

£100: 1010 Mya McNulty – *Dolores Houston*

£100: 1258 Corrine Hannigan – *Elizabeth O'Hare*

£100: 1507 Jacintha Gillespie - *Elizabeth O'Hare*

Forty Hours Adoration – St Mary's Melmount

Join us for **Forty Hours Adoration** in **St Mary's Melmount** between **26th and 27th October 2025**.

You can view or download the full programme by opening the link below. *To open in a new tab, right-click and select "Open link in new tab", or hold **Ctrl** (Windows) / **Cmd** (Mac) and click.*



[View Forty Hours Adoration PDF](#)



[Sign-Up Sheet \(PDF\)](#)

40 Hours Adoration St Mary's, Melmount

26th – 27th October 2025

*You are invited to commit to a period of prayer before the Lord.
Please let us know what period you will cover by filling out a
Commitment Card and posting in the Box here or by posting into
Fr Sean or the Parish Office or send details by email*

Sunday 26th October 2025

8.00am Morning Prayer
11.30am Mass
3.00pm Divine Mercy Chaplet
6.00pm Holy Hour: Angelus, Evening Prayer
and Stations of the Cross
9.00pm Rosary (Glorious Mysteries)
9.30pm Night Prayer



Monday 27th October 2025

12.00am Rosary (Mysteries of Light)
3.00am Rosary (Sorrowful Mysteries)
6.00am Angelus and Chaplet for Priests
8.00am Morning Prayer & Rosary (Joyful Mysteries)
10.00am Mass
12.00pm Angelus and Midday Prayer
3.00pm Divine Mercy Chaplet
6.00pm Angelus and Chaplet for Priests
8.00pm Holy Hour: Evening Prayer and Rosary
9.30pm Night Prayer
12.00am Solemn Benediction to conclude the 40 Hours



Mourne Pastoral Area – Melmount and Sion Mills Parishes
41 Melmount Road, Strabane, BT82 9EF. Office: 028 7188 3777 Fr Sean: 028 7188 2648
Office: parishoffice@melmountparish.com Fr Sean: sean.odonnell@derrydiocese.org

The Parish of Moville

St Pius X, Moville St Mary's, Ballybrack

St Columba's, Ballinacrae St Joseph's Oratory, Shrove



Parish Priest: Fr Colm O'Doherty (074) 9382057

Parish Office: (074) 9382057/0899421375

emails: movilleparish@derrydiocese.org
movilleparish@gmail.com

Bulletin email address: movillebulletin@gmail.com

Parish website: www.movilleparish.com

CALENDAR FOR THE WEEK AHEAD

Sunday 16th There is a great mystery in the will of God that all will be saved. He knows the minds and hearts of all and does not judge in a human way. We hold to that belief in the need of membership for salvation, but we do so in the light of the universality of salvation. Like the Canaanite woman we must persevere with a determined faith in seeking the truth in love, until all nations learn of God's salvation and all peoples praise his name.

Monday 17th Our Lady of Knock. Our Lady is believed to have appeared at the south gable of Knock Parish Church on 21 August 1879 in the company of St Joseph and St John the Evangelist. There were fifteen witnesses, young and old, to the apparition. Knock is an internationally recognised Marian shrine and was visited by Pope St. John Paul II as part of his 1979 pilgrimage to Ireland, and by Pope Francis when he visited Ireland for the World Meeting of Families in 2018.

Wednesday 19th St John Eudes (1601-1680), from Normandy, spent a fruitful twenty years with the French Oratory. He founded a congregation to improve the standards of the clergy through seminaries. He also founded the Sisters of Our Lady of Charity and Refuge. A powerful preacher, he was among the first to promote devotion to the Sacred Heart.

Thursday 20th St Bernard (1090-1153), abbot and doctor of the Church. Became a Cistercian monk at Citeaux in 1113 and became abbot of Clairvaux in 1115. A figure of great influence in his day, and even later through his writings.

Friday 21st St Pius X (1835-1914) became Pope in 1903. He encouraged pastoral liturgy and sacramental practice, especially of frequent communion to which he admitted young children.

Saturday 22nd The Queenship of Mary. During the Middle Ages, Mary was venerated as queen of the angels and saints. Pope Pius XII prescribed the memorial for the universal church in 1955, at the close of the Marian Year. Its place on this date to stress the connection of Mary's queenship with the Assumption.

Sunday 23rd 11.30am Mass will be celebrated in Ballinacrae.
 First Anniversary for John Ward at 10am in St Pius X.

Mass this week in St Pius X: Monday to Friday 10am. Saturday 6.30pm; Sunday 10am.

Confessions in St. Pius X Church: Saturday 5.45pm to 6.15pm.

The Rosary and the Divine Mercy Chaplet will be recited in St. Pius X Church, Moville, at 7.30pm every day, from Sunday – Friday. **Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament** on Monday, 2-9pm; Wednesday, 6-9pm.

We offer our **sympathy** to the families and friends of Kathleen Morris, Taobh na Cille, who died recently. May she rest in peace.

Thank you for your generous financial support to the parish in the past week, which amounted to €3020 and for the following donation – €2000 and £100.

If you'd like to receive a copy of the **parish newsletter** by email, please send an email to: movillebulletin@gmail.com The newsletter will be sent out securely, giving no one else access to your email address, in accordance with GDPR.

Prayer for Vocations: That the men called to priesthood will "...have a care for justice [and] act with integrity..." as they preach the message of God's salvation for everyone, the Good News that the Church is "...a house of prayer for all the peoples." We pray to the Lord.

"It is to the glory of my Father that you should bear much fruit and then you will be my disciples." Are you being called to love the Lord and His people as a priest, sister or brother? Anyone interested in serving the Church as a priest of the diocese of Derry should contact the diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, PP Bellaghy and Greenlough, at 0487938 6259 or at pgoh2111@gmail.com

Music continues on Thursday evenings at 8pm in Moville Men's Shed. Love Music? Just Show Up! Singers, players, and socialisers alike are all welcome for a relaxing evening at one of the few Shed activities open to both men and women.

A Feast of Folk with Patsy Cavanagh and friends in The Cairn, at 8pm every Tuesday during July and August. Ballads and Folk songs from Ireland and further afield as seating is limited, please call 9381104.

Serenity House (9382945) serenityhouse@eircom.net **Coffee Morning** on Friday 21 August, from 10 am-2 pm. Hosted by Anne Mullan, in aid of the Letterkenny Oncology Department.

Greencastle Community Centre (9381054) info@greencastlecentre.ie – Free Bridge Builders Adventure Camp (25, 26, 27 August) for 13 to 16 year olds – bushcrafts, coasteering, and outdoor adventures. Baby Reflexology with Chantel from Tuesday 1 September. Call 0863137817 to register. QQI Level 5 Certificate in Healthcare Support starting in September.

Names are being taken for **Bridge Classes**, commencing mid-September. To register or for further information please contact Margaret on 0863936255 as soon as possible

Carrowmena Community Centre (9367061) Cream Teas every Tuesday during August from between 2 and 4pm. Cost €5. Special summer dance (The Holiday Hop), for regulars, holiday makers and visitors, on Sunday 16 August at 8pm. Admission €5, including supper. All welcome. Carrowmena Community Centre, Carrowmena Residents Association and Tremone Historical Society will hold an afternoon celebrating the heritage, people and stories of the area on Sunday 30 August at 2pm. Proceeds to the Residents Association and the Memorial Garden Renovation Fund. Tickets €10. Booking essential.

St Joseph's Men's Camino, a 25km pilgrimage organised by the Dominicans, takes place in The Boyne Valley on Saturday 12 September. Visit www.dominicans.ie/events for details

Draw Promoters – would you please begin taking names for the new draw as Monday 5 September will be last in the present series.

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Frank Molloy, Maureen Devine, Eunan Herron

Tommy Finlay, Harry McCrossan, Anne McCay

Magdalene Curry, Molly McDaid, David Coyle

Deirdre Drumm Pearce, Dessie Drumm, Grace Drumm

Noel Brennan, Joe McNulty, Alice Alexander

Robert Brennan, George Fitzpatrick, Francis Moss

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Last week's collections amounted to: **Melmount:** £3373.00; **Sion Mills:** £1465.00. Thank you. Those who pay to the weekly collection or any special collections, including Priest's Collection by cheque are asked that all cheques should be made payable to 'Melmount Parish' or 'Sion Mills Parish' depending on the Parish. This is a banking requirement. *Parishioners can still leave their contributions in the Parish Office. If the Office is closed, please use the letterbox.*

Parish Bulletin This is the last bulletin until September.

Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament will take place in St. Mary's, Melmount tomorrow, Monday 13 July after 10.00am Mass until 6.30pm.

Vocations We pray for the men called to serve the Church as priests of our diocese, that their hearts will be the fertile soil Jesus needs to receive the seed which is His Word, and that they will spread His Word, His Good News, by their preaching and by the example of their lives.

Adoration Everyday The Blessed Sacrament can be adored in the Adoration Room, St. Theresa's, Sion Mills anytime while the church is open.

Baptism Dates Melmount

July: Sunday 19; Saturday 25; Sunday 26.

August: Saturday 8; Saturday 29.

September: Saturday 5; Sunday 13; Saturday 19.

October: Sunday 4; Saturday 10; Saturday 17; Saturday 24.

November: Sunday 8; Saturday 14; Saturday 21; Saturday 28.

Baptisms will be at 3.30pm on a Saturday and 12.45pm on a Sunday.

To book a Baptism contact the Parish Office on 71383777 during office hours.

Accord Marriage Preparation Courses (Pre-Marriage Courses) will take place in September 25/26 and November 20/21. All courses are now online for booking at www.accordni.com

Please Note: These courses are in person and not online courses.

Accord Derry will NOT be facilitating courses during October or December.

Safeguarding Notice If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email@ dlp@derrydiocese.org. *Northern Ireland emergency services:* PSNI on 101; *Social Services:* Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 71314090 and ask for the Duty Social Worker. *Regional Emergency Social Work Services* 0800 1979 995.

The Parish Draws for July and August took place on Wednesday 8 July. The winners are as follows:

July Draw

£500: 1027 Genevieve O'Neill – *Genevieve O'Neill*
£250: 1350 Concepta McGarrigle – *Ann Donaghey*
£250: 1708 Thomas Moore – *Teresa Quigg*
£250: 1338 Marianne Patton – *Carol-ann Stewart*
£150: 1995 Tammy McNulty – *Irene Callan*
£150: 1304 Ina O'Neill – *Sheelagh McKelvey*
£150: 1719 Christine McHugh – *Teresa Quigg*
£100: 1243 Bronagh Lynch – *Declan Duffy*
£100: 1669 Declan McColgan – *Madeleine McColgan*
£100: 1702 Terrie Logue - *Genevieve O'Neill*

August Draw

£500: 1756 Vincent McCarron – *Katrina Houston*
£250: 1626 Anne Neeson – *Madeleine McColgan*
£250: 1379 Gary McNicholl – *Sheelagh McKelvey*
£250: 1862 Emma Lynch – *Elizabeth O'Hare*
£150: 1825 Susan McGuinness – *John Donohoe*
£150: 1684 Teresa Boggs – *Katrina Houston*
£150: 1380 Bridget McCrory – *Sheelagh McKelvey*
£100: 1010 Mya McNulty – *Dolores Houston*
£100: 1258 Corrine Hannigan – *Elizabeth O'Hare*
£100: 1507 Jacintha Gillespie - *Elizabeth O'Hare*



CATHOLICIRELAND.NET
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1 Latest News

2 Remembering our Dead.

3 WEBCAM

4 Prayers For Protection

5 Mass Times

6 Getting Married

A short reflection on today's Gospel Matthew 15:21-28

Today's Gospel contains an exchange between Jesus and a Canaanite woman in which Jesus appears to exercise racism and elitism to a degree which shocks us to the core. But is this what is really taking place! Is Jesus a victim of inherited prejudice and an unquestioning acceptance of Jewish supremacy? Or is he demonstrating effectively what happens when we fail to reach out in love to all mankind: when we fail to realise that it is God's will and the will of Jesus, His beloved Son, for us to grow in universal love and care as opposed to self-love, racism and the false notion of selected supremacy! What happens is that a child remains suffering in torment while a loving mother is forced to watch on in helpless anguish. Jesus always sees into the truth which lives in the heart. He sees into the heart of the Canaanite woman. He sees her love for her tormented child. He sees her willingness to suffer insult for the sake of her child. And he sees her unflinching faith in him as her child's only hope.

Jesus, may we grow and mature daily in universal love and care, away from 'self-love and elitism' in the knowledge that it is your will that we do so.

Prayer for Vocations to the Priesthood: That the men called to priesthood will "... have a care for justice (and) act with integrity..." as they preach the message of God's salvation for everyone, the Good News that the Church is "a house of prayer for all the peoples".

"Bishop Daly - A Man for all Seasons" 2026 Exhibition celebrates the life, influence, work and legacy of Bishop Edward Daly opened on Saturday 8th August at 11.00am. Exhibition times are 11.00am to 4.00pm in the Conference Room above the Sacristy in Saint Eugene's Cathedral, Creggan Street, Derry, BT48 9AP. The Exhibition will run until 18th August and everyone is welcome.

The National Novena to Our Lady of Knock takes place at Knock Shrine from Thursday 13th to Friday 21st August 2026. Novena ceremonies will be celebrated daily at 3.00pm and 8.00pm, with workshops and guided prayer sessions also taking place throughout the nine days. This year's theme is "Sheltered in God's Love." See the full program at www.knockshrine.ie.

The St Dymphna Mass with Anointing of the Sick will be celebrated at St Eugene's Cathedral on Tuesday 18 August at 7.30pm. This Mass is to give thanks to God for positive mental health and to pray for those who are struggling with mental health issues and those who care for them.

Prayer to Our Lady of Mental Peace

Mother of tranquillity, Mother of Hope, Our Lady of Mental Peace. We reach out to you for what is needful in our weakness. Teach a searching heart that God's love is unchanging, that human love begins and grows by touching God's love.

Let your gentle peace – which the world cannot give – be always with me. And help me to bring this same peace into the lives of others.

Our Lady of Mental Peace – pray for me.

Sympathy

We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of:

Bobby Moran

Kay Callaghan

May they rest in peace

Anniversaries

Please pray for the repose of the souls of:

Sibeal Sharkey

Kathleen Bierwas

Martin Gillespie

Sean Paul Boyle

Majella Quigley

May they rest in peace

Baptisms

We welcome as members of God's family:

Daire Bennett Cassidy

Harrison Dean Quigley

To book a Baptism contact the Parish Office 02871 262894

Collection

Weekly Collection: £5,273

Parish Development: £1,016

Thank you for your generosity

Thank you

Fr Farren acknowledges with thanks the following donations for:

Smile Train: £50, £30, £200

Sightsavers: £50, £30, £10, £200

Mary's Meals: £30

Hungry Children: £5

Trócaire: £200

St Vincent de Paul: £200

Concern: £200

Readers for 22nd/23rd August

6.15pm Amulya George

7.30pm Garth Tucker

9.30am Kay McGinn

11.00am Mickey Kerr

12.30pm Michael Wilson

7.00pm Marian Boyle

Sacrament of Marriage

We congratulate

Fiona Corr & Stephen Matthewson

Lauren Doherty & Caolan Cassidy

who celebrated the Sacrament of Marriage recently in the Cathedral

May God bless you abundantly in love, joy and happiness

St Joseph's Boys' School – Return to school information:

Year 12 and 14 – Monday 24 August 2026

Year 9, Year 10 and Year 11 – Wednesday 26 August 2026

Year 8 and Year 13 – Friday 28 August 2026

All year groups full return – Tuesday 1st September 2026 – **All classes will attend from Tuesday 1st September from 8.40am – 3.00pm**

Job Opportunity, Derry Diocesan Trust: Administrative & Financial Officer (18 hours per week), Waterside Parish, Parochial House, 32 Chapel Road, Derry. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hr - £13.50 per hr. For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or telephone 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12 noon Monday 24 August 2026. *Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.*

*Vol 54 No 32
Twentieth Sunday
in Ordinary Time
16th August 2026*

Priests: Fr Paul Farren, Fr Shaun Doherty

Personal Assistants Wanted: The Churches Trust is recruiting people for flexible part-time work supporting and befriending elderly people living independently at home. No experience required – training and support provided. Full clean driving licence and access to a vehicle is required. For more information, call **02871 311322**.

Accord Derry – Marriage Preparation Workshops 2026 - Accord Derry is pleased to announce upcoming Marriage Preparation Workshops taking place in 2026. These courses are designed to support couples as they prepare for the Sacrament of Marriage. The remaining available dates for 2026 are as follows:

- **September:** 25th–26th 2026
- **November:** 20th–21st 2026

All courses are now available for online booking at: www.accordni.com.

Please note that **Accord Derry will not be facilitating Marriage Preparation Courses during October or December 2026**. Couples are encouraged to book early to secure a place on their preferred date.

St Eugene's Cathedral is monitored by CCTV cameras and by two live streaming cameras. Live streaming can be viewed online at www.churchservices.tv, www.watchmcnmedia or the parish website. The Diocese of Derry Privacy Notice is displayed on the parish website and Cathedral notice board, or you may obtain a copy from the Parish Office.

Safeguarding Notice: If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

Northern Ireland emergency services: PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland): 101 Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust: 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker), Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust: 028 9442 4459, Regional Emergency Social Work Services: 0800 1979 995. Republic of Ireland emergency services: Garda Síochána Buncrana: 00353 749 320 540 Letterkenny: 00353 749 167 100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency: 00353 749 102 23

 Bulletin

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Sunday 9th August
Sunday 2nd August
Sunday 26th July
Sunday 19th July
Sunday 12th July
Sunday 5th July
Sunday 28th June
Sunday 21st June
Sunday 14th June
Sunday 7th June
Sunday 31st May
Sunday 24th May
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Sunday 8th June

Sunday 1st June

Sunday 25th May

Sunday 18th May

Sunday 11th May

Sunday 4th May

Sunday 27th April

Sunday 20th April

Sunday 13th April

Sunday 6th April

Sunday 30th March

Sunday 23rd March

Sunday 16th March

Sunday 9th March

Sunday 2nd March

Sunday 23rd February

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Sunday 8th December

Sunday 1st December

Sunday 24th November

Sunday 17th November

Sunday 10th November

Sunday 3rd November
Sunday 27th October
Sunday 20th October
Sunday 13th October

Saint Mary's Creggan

📍 ADDRESS: 1 Fanad Dr, Derry BT48 9QE | 📞 PHONE: 02871263152

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Steelstown Parish Newsletter

Eighteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Sunday 2nd August 2026

Thoughts on the Gospel

Matthew 14:13–21 – The Feeding of the Five Thousand

The miracle of the loaves and fishes begins with **compassion**. Before Jesus fed the crowd, He first recognised their suffering and their need. His heart was moved by those who were tired, hungry, and searching for hope.

In our own busy lives, God gently calls us to notice those around us who may be lonely, discouraged, forgotten, or struggling. A simple word of encouragement, a listening ear, or a small act of kindness may become someone else's miracle.

The disciples looked only at what they **didn't have**. Faced with thousands of hungry people, they saw only five loaves and two fish. Jesus, however, asked them to offer what they already possessed.

God rarely asks us for what we do not have. Instead, He asks us to place before Him our time, our talents, our compassion, and our willingness to serve. However small these gifts may seem, He is able to multiply them beyond anything we could imagine.

Before distributing the food, Jesus lifted everything to His Father in prayer. This reminds us that surrender is not a sign of weakness or defeat. Rather, it is an act of trust. We all carry burdens that feel too heavy or situations that seem impossible, yet when we place them into God's hands, what appears insufficient can become more than enough.

Finally, the twelve baskets of leftovers remind us of God's overwhelming generosity. His blessings are never intended to stop with us but to flow through us. When we forgive generously, encourage freely, and share what we have with others, God's grace continues to multiply in countless lives.

Prayer

Lord, fill our hearts with compassion. Use the little we have to accomplish great things for Your Kingdom. Teach us to trust You completely, to surrender our limitations into Your hands, and to share Your blessings generously with all whom we meet. Amen.

Readings for Next Sunday

Sunday 9th August 2026

First Reading: 1 Kings 19:9a, 11–13a

Psalm: Psalm 85:9–14

Second Reading: Romans 9:1–5

Gospel: Matthew 14:22–33

Saints of the Coming Week

Tuesday

- St John Vianney, Priest

Wednesday

- The Dedication of the Basilica of St Mary Major (Rome)

Thursday

- The Transfiguration of the Lord

Friday

- St Cajetan, Priest
- St Sixtus II, Pope, and Companions, Martyrs

Saturday

- St Dominic, Priest
-

Pope's Prayer Intention for August

For Evangelisation in the City

Let us pray that in large cities, often marked by anonymity and loneliness, we may discover new ways of proclaiming the Gospel, finding creative paths to build genuine Christian communities.

Prayer for Vocations

We pray for men whom God is calling to the priesthood.

Like Jesus in today's Gospel, may they never turn away from the poor, the hungry, the vulnerable or those most in need, but always reflect the compassionate love of Christ as they nourish His people through the Word of God and the Eucharist.

Parish & Diocesan Notices

Rosary on the Coast

Today (Sunday) at 3.00 pm

 Lisfannon Beach

Praying for **peace, Ireland and our unborn children.**

Everyone is warmly welcome.

Give Blood – Save Lives

The **Northern Ireland Blood Transfusion Service** will hold a blood donor session at:

Lisneal College

70 Crescent Link

Derry BT47 5FQ

Monday 4th August

- 12.30 pm – 4.00 pm
- 5.00 pm – 7.30 pm

 Freephone: **0808 553 4653** to book.

Franciscan Friary, Rossnowlagh

Monthly Healing Service

Today (Sunday)

- Rosary – **2.45 pm**
 - Mass & Healing Service – **3.00 pm**
 - Confessions – **2.00 pm – 5.00 pm**
-

ACCORD Marriage Preparation

Marriage preparation courses are available throughout the year.

Please visit www.accordni.com for dates and booking information.

Monthly Mass for Sr Clare Crockett

Sunday 9th August

7.00 pm

Carmelite Retreat Centre
Termonbacca, Derry

Day of Healing & Prayer

House of Prayer, Clonfert

Saturday 15th August

Led by **Eddie Stone**

A bus will travel from **Letterkenny**, collecting pilgrims in **Ballybofey** and **Donegal Town**.
A priest will accompany the pilgrimage.

 **Contact: 086 393 6547**

Walk in Our Patron Saint's Footsteps

St Patrick's Way Pilgrim Walk

Saturday 8th August

9.00 am – 3.00 pm

Downpatrick

Guides:

- Martina Purdy
- Elaine Kelly

Cost: £55

 **028 4461 9000**

Visit www.saintpatrickcentre.com

Youth & Young Adults

Embrace the Grace

Legion of Mary Young Adult Catholic Conference

(Ages 18–40)

Saturday 29th August

9.30 am – 6.00 pm

De Montfort House
Morning Star Avenue
Dublin D07 VA03

Tickets available through Eventbrite (search **Embrace the Grace**).

Youth 2000 Summer Festival

13th–16th August

Newbridge College, Kildare

Young people aged **16–35** are invited to enjoy:

- Inspiring talks
- Workshops
- Daily Mass
- Music and Prayer
- Fellowship
- Free buses
- All meals included

Visit **youth2000.ie** or follow **@Youth2000Ireland**.

Anam Óg Summer Scheme

3rd–7th August

12.00 pm – 4.00 pm daily

Termonbacca, Derry

For children aged **8–14**

Faith, friendship, games, arts & crafts, adventure and prayer.

Email:

termonbaccaderry@ocd.ie

Community & Charity

Mary's Meals

Annual Step by Step Walk

Sunday 9th August

12.00 noon

Starting from:

Sainsbury's Car Park

Strand Road, Derry

Walking the Foyle Bridge and Peace Bridge.

Everyone is welcome—even if only for part of the walk.

Mary's Meals currently provides a daily school meal to **over 3 million children across 16 countries.**

Please keep all participants in your prayers.

Family Carers Ireland

Remote one-to-one support clinics are available **every Tuesday throughout August.**

Carers can speak privately from the comfort of their own homes.

 086 836 3842

 Donegalcs@familycarers.ie

Pro-Life Events

Donegal Pro Life Church Gate Collection

Saturday 15th & Sunday 16th August

Countywide Collection

Volunteers are greatly appreciated.

 Margaret:
00353 89 246 9599

Míle buíochas.

Monthly Pro-Life Witness

Friday 7th August
1.00 pm – 2.00 pm

Roundabout at Letterkenny University Hospital.

Everyone welcome.

Pilgrimages

Lough Derg Annual Fundraising Draw

Support Station Island and help preserve this special place of pilgrimage for future generations.

Tickets

- Single: **€10**
- Book of 6: **€50**

Those returning a full book will also be entered into the **Early Bird Draw on 28th August 2026.**

Main Draw

23rd October 2026

Prizes

 €10,000

 €5,000

 €2,000

4th – €1,500

5th – €1,000

6th – €500

Lough Derg Day Retreats

As the Three-Day Pilgrimage season concludes (final day to begin is **13th August**), Day Retreats resume on:

- August: **18, 22, 23, 29 & 31**
- September: **5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19 & 20**

Take time away from the busyness of everyday life for guided prayer, quiet reflection and spiritual renewal.

Advance booking is essential.

Employment Opportunity

Administrative & Financial Officer

Clonmany Parish

The **Derry Diocesan Trust** invites applications for the position of:

Administrative & Financial Officer

Hours: 9 per week

Application packs are available from:

Bishop's House
St Eugene's Cathedral
Derry BT48 9AP

 028 7126 2302

 recruitment@derrydiocese.org

Closing Date: Tuesday **11th August 2026**

Publications

Reflections Through Poetry

A beautiful collection by **Fr John P. Forbes**

Available from the **Pastoral Office**

Price: £10

All proceeds support **Children in Crossfire** and the **Cause for the Canonisation of Sr Clare Crockett**.

Sharing the Good News

Read the latest weekly Catholic e-zine featuring news, reflections and resources from across Ireland.

Visit [**theway.ie/ezine-2/**](http://theway.ie/ezine-2/).

Closing Prayer

May the Lord bless us with compassionate hearts, generous spirits, and unwavering trust in His providence. May we recognise Christ in those around us, offer Him the little we possess, and witness His abundant blessings multiplying in our families, our parish, and our community.

May Almighty God bless you, the Father, ✠ the Son, and the Holy Spirit. Amen.



PARISH NEWSLETTER

T: 028 7126 2360 E: threepatrons@derrydiocese.org W: threepatrons.org

Fr Micheál McGavigan PP – Fr Roni Zacharias CC – Fr Stephen Ward CC

Sunday 16th August 2026 – Twentieth Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A

The Gospel for this Sunday recounts Jesus' encounter with a Canaanite woman whose daughter is tormented by a demon (Matthew 15:21-28). Initially, Jesus appears dismissive, stating that He was sent only to the lost sheep of Israel and even comparing her to a dog unworthy of the children's bread. Yet, the woman persists, humbly acknowledging her need and demonstrating remarkable faith. Her courage and persistence lead Jesus to commend her faith and heal her daughter.

This passage challenges us to reflect on faith and humility. True faith is not about pretending to be strong; it is about admitting our need for God and asking for help, even when answers seem delayed or social barriers make it difficult. The woman's example teaches that persistence in prayer and trust in God's mercy can overcome obstacles and bring about transformation, both for ourselves and others.

WELCOME TO GOD'S FAMILY

Méabh Eileen McGlinchey; Lana McCready;
Reuben John Cruickshank-McCloskey; Callum Patrick O'Neill;
Luca Pearse O'Doherty; Shane Duddy; Shea William Curran;
Rúa Maeve McGeady; Darragh Christian McGeady;

REQUIESCANT IN PACE

We offer our sympathies to the family and friends of:
John Coyle, Glen Road; Sarah (Ellen) Kelly, Leafair Park;
Lenny Cooper, Fortwilliam Terrace;
Frank Downey, Messines Park.

ANNIVERSARIES

Malachy Bradley; Hugh D'Arcy; Tommy Mullany;
Kathleen Coyle; Michael Farren Jnr; Andy Barr; Brendan Gillen;
Mary Grant; Gerard McKinney; Neil Doran; Kathleen Dunne;
Lee Brinkley; Bridget Halford; Bridie Doherty; Charlie Large;
Rosie O'Doherty.

STILL YOUNG AT HEART

My deepest gratitude and appreciation go to parishioners who acknowledged my recent 'significant birthday' in a variety of ways. Your thoughtfulness and kindness are greatly appreciated. What was expected to be a quiet and little-known occasion turned out to be filled with sincere congratulations and best wishes which have filled me with joy and touched me in a way which will never be forgotten. Many thanks for the memories. *Fr Peter.*

READINGS FOR SUNDAY 23rd AUGUST

1st Isaiah 22:19-23. Psalm: 137: 1-3, 6, 8, R/v 8.
2nd Romans 11:33-36. Gospel Matthew 16:13-20.

SIMPLE FAMILY PRAYER BOOK

This Sunday begins psalter week 4.

PILGRIMAGE TO CYPRUS

The parish is considering a 7-night pilgrimage to Cyprus from 16-23 May 2027, following in the footsteps of St Paul and St Barnabas. The pilgrimage would include visits to many of Cyprus's most important Christian and historical sites, with the opportunity to celebrate Mass in places closely associated with the early Church.

The package includes direct flights from Belfast, full-board accommodation in a four-star seafront hotel, and a guided programme of pilgrimage visits throughout the week. The estimated cost is £1,675 per person. At this stage, we are simply seeking expressions of interest. If you think you may wish to join the pilgrimage, please contact the parish office. Registering your interest is not a commitment to travel.

VOCATIONS

That the men called to priesthood will "...
have a care for justice [and] act with integrity..."
as they preach the message of God's salvation for everyone,
the Good News that the Church is "...
a house of prayer for all the peoples."

LAST WEEK'S OFFERTORY COLLECTION

St Patrick's Church: £1,388 - St Brigid's Church: £2,097 - St Joseph's Church: £990
2nd Collection (Maintenance & Pastoral Outreach): £1,047.

Thank you for your continued generosity.

**BANK DETAILS FOR ONLINE DONATIONS: A/C Name: The Parish of the Three Patrons
Sort Code: 95-06-79 A/C No: 60320021**

JOB OPPORTUNITY, DERRY DIOCESAN TRUST:

Administrative & Financial Officer (18 hours per week), Waterside Parish, Parochial House, 32 Chapel Road, Derry. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hr - £13.50 per hour. For an application pack please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or tel 028 7126 2302.

Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12 noon Monday 24 August 2026.

Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

THE CHURCHES TRUST

We are currently recruiting for our Community Support Service based in the city. This service provides much needed befriending for elderly living independently at home. Flexible Part-Time Work as a Personal Assistant - We're looking for caring, reliable individuals to join our panel of self-employed personal assistants. Set your own hours. Earn extra income

Make a difference in your community. No experience required, we provide training and support. Applicants should have full, clean driving license and access to a vehicle. Apply today and start helping those in need, call 028 71311322 for more information.

MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND

Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential Weekend from Friday 2 to Sunday 4 October 2026 at the Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare. Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage. Visit www.marriageencounter.ie

ROSARY ON THE COAST

Today, Sunday 16th August in Benone Beach. All welcome.

'EMBRACE THE GRACE'

Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August 2026 - a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. It will be a chance to build faith in friendship with young adults from across the country. Saturday 30 August from 9.30am to 6pm with a social afterwards. Tickets €20 and can be booked on the eventbrite website by looking up 'Embrace the Grace'. Further queries contact: deusetpatria@gmail.com

THE NATIONAL NOVENA TO OUR LADY OF KNOCK

Takes place at Knock Shrine from Thursday 13 to Friday 21 August 2026. Novena ceremonies will be celebrated daily at 3pm and 8pm, with workshops and guided prayer sessions also taking place throughout the nine days. This year's theme is "Sheltered in God's Love." Everyone is very welcome.

See the full programme at: <https://www.knockshrine.ie/national-novena-2026-guest-speakers-and-programme/>

ST PIO CAFÉ

The Café at St Pio house will be closed for the next few weeks and will reopen on Tuesday 2nd September. We thank all those who help to make this such a success.

PRIVACY NOTICE

Is available on the parish website: threepatrons.org

SAFEGUARDING

If you have any concerns about the Safeguarding of Children or vulnerable adults within the Church, please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596500793 or at dlp@derrydiocese.org

PARISH GROUPS & MEETINGS (SUMMER)

Monday	After 11am Mass 1pm – 2.30pm 7pm - 9pm	Holy Souls Prayer Group Legion of Mary Woman's Craft Group	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh Meeting Room, St Joseph's Church, Galliagh Kildare Room, Carnhill
Tuesday	After 11am Mass 11.30am - 2.30pm 7.30pm - 9.30pm	Devotion to the Holy Face St. Pio's Café Living Disciples Prayer Group	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh St Pio Centre, Galliagh (Closed until September) St Pio Centre, Galliagh
Thursday	11.30am - 2.30pm 6pm – 7pm 7pm – 8pm 7.30pm - 8.30pm 8.15pm – 10pm	St. Pio's Café Divine Will Prayer Group Holy Hour for the Unborn Youth Prayer Group Be Still – Men's Prayer Group	St. Pio Centre, Galliagh (Closed until September) Kildare Room, Carnhill Our Lady's Chapel St. Pio Centre, Galliagh Our Lady's Chapel
Friday	11.30am-12.30pm	Divine Mercy Prayer Group	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh

PARISH SCHEDULE - SUMMER**ST PATRICK'S CHURCH, PENNYBURN**

Sunday Mass:	Vigil 6.15pm; 9.45am
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 10am
Confessions:	Saturday: 5.15pm – 6pm
Baptisms:	Saturday: 4.30pm; Sunday: 1.30pm

ST BRIGID'S CHURCH, CARNHILL

Sunday Mass:	Vigil 5pm; 10.30am & 12.30pm
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 9.30am; Saturday: 11am
Confessions:	Saturday after 11.00am Mass and 4pm - 4.45pm
Eucharistic Adoration:	Daily: 8.00am – 8.00pm in St Carlo Acutis Chapel
Baptisms:	Saturday: 3.30pm

ST JOSEPH'S CHURCH, GALLIAGH

Sunday Mass:	11.00am; 12.30pm (<i>An tAifreann Naofa</i>); 6.30pm
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 11am
Confessions:	Sunday: 5.30pm – 6.15pm
Eucharistic Adoration:	Tuesday: 11.30am – 1pm in Our Lady's Chapel
Baptisms:	Saturday: 3.30pm

Parishes of Glendermott & Strathfoyle

Sunday 16th August 2026

Twentieth Sunday in Ordinary Time

“Woman, you have great faith”

The Canaanite woman in the Gospel appears almost to be the opposite of Peter from last week whom Jesus accused of having little faith. As an outsider, she comes to him with a mother’s urgent prayer: “Lord, help me.” At first her plea seems to meet silence and resistance. Yet she does not walk away: she remains humble, courageous, and persistent, trusting that even the smallest share in God’s mercy is enough to bring healing.

Her faith it is not loud in a demanding entitled way. She displays a strong faith in the sense of refusing to give up on Jesus. She, an outsider, recognises him as Lord and places before him the suffering of someone she loves. Many of us will know something of that prayer: the prayer made beside a hospital bed, for a family member in difficulty, for a child who has lost their way, or for a burden that we carry that seems slow to lift.

Jesus’ final words to her are full of hope: “Woman, you have great faith.” The Gospel reminds us that God’s mercy is wider than our boundaries. The first reading speaks of God’s house as “a house of prayer for all peoples,” and the Gospel shows that promise beginning to unfold in the life of Christ. No one who turns to the Lord with faith is beyond his compassion.

This Gospel is both comforting and challenging. It comforts us by teaching us to persevere in prayer, even when answers seem delayed. It challenges us to become a community where those who feel distant, overlooked, or outside the usual circle can still encounter welcome, dignity, and mercy. This week, let us pray with the Canaanite woman’s simple words: “Lord, help me.” And let us ask for the grace to see others with the generous heart of Christ.

We pray for **Maureen McCauley** of Camelia Court and **David Phillips** of Chapel Road both of whom were buried following Requiem Masses on Saturday

Anniversaries – We are asked to remember in prayer: Celine Friel, Jim Quigley, Ethna McGrath, John Minahan, Tommy McNaught, Helen Cairns, Terry Doherty.

Vocations – We pray for the men called to priesthood. That the men called to priesthood will "...have a care for justice [and] act with integrity..." as they preach the message of God's salvation for everyone, the Good News that the Church is "...a house of prayer for all the peoples." For those interested or even wish to enquire about a call to diocesan priesthood, please contact Fr. Pat O'Hagan, Vocations Director for the Diocese of Derry at pgoh2111@gmail.com

Vocations Society of St Joseph (Waterside Parish) We continue to pray for priests, vocations to priesthood and religious life and support seminarians. The Rosary on Thursday mornings at 9.30am offered for this intention and everyone welcome.

Lectio Divina – Join us on **Thursday** evenings at 8:00pm in St Columb's Church for our weekly praying of the Sacred Scriptures.

Offertory Collections: Glendermott: £4,080.00 Strathfoyle: £660.00

Thank you for your generosity to the parish collections.

Are you interested in volunteering to help children and adults in our parish to prepare to receive the Sacraments? If you have a basic knowledge of Catholic teaching and some teaching experience (not essential), please contact the Parish Office Tel. 02871 342303. You will join a small parish team and be supported in preparing and delivering sessions. The time commitment would be around 2 hours per week from end of September to May. Safeguarding checks will be carried out.

***"He who sings, prays twice."* (St Augustine)** – St Columb's church choir is on its summer break for the months of **July & August** and will resume in September. We are constantly looking for new singers, maybe you would consider joining, just come along and give it a try or talk to Marcus or any choir members.

Administrative & Financial Officer (18 hours pw), Waterside Parish, Parochial House, 32 Chapel Road, Derry. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hr - £13.50 per hr. For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or tel 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12 noon Monday 24th August 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

Accord Derry - Marriage Preparation Workshops - September and November 2026. September 25th/26th 2026 – November 20th/21st 2026. These courses are now online for booking at www.accordni.com **Please note** that Accord Derry will **NOT** be facilitating courses during October or December 2026.

'Embrace the Grace' Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August 2026 - Legion of Mary: 'Embrace the Grace' is a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. This event takes place on Saturday 30 August from 9.30am to 6.00pm with a social afterwards. Any queries can be directed towards deusetpatria@gmail.com.

The Churches Trust are currently recruiting for our Community Support Service based in the city. This service provides much needed befriending for elderly living independently at home. Flexible Part-Time Work as a Personal Assistant We're looking for caring, reliable individuals to join our panel of self-employed personal assistants. Set your own hours. Earn extra income. Make a difference in your community No experience required, we provide training and support. Applicants should have full, clean driving license and access to a vehicle. Apply today and start helping those in need. Call 028 71311322 for more info.

Rosary on the beach taking place this Sunday 16th August at 3.00pm at Benone

Exam results time We remember in prayer in a special way those in our parish who have or are receiving exam results around this time and are making decisions on their future.

Holy Spirit source of wisdom and truth
Guide my thoughts words and actions

Help me to discern God's will in all things for my future. Give me courage to follow the path you place before me and the grace to trust in your direction.
Lead me always closer to Christ. Amen

Mass & Confession Times

Sunday

St Columb's Church	10.00am, 12.30pm & 6.00pm
Church of Immaculate Conception	10.15am & 12.15pm
St Oliver Plunkett Church	11.15am
St Mary's Oratory	9.15am

Monday – Friday

St Columb's Church	10.00am & 7.30pm
Church of Immaculate Conception	9.15am (Monday – Friday)
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	11.00am (Mon, Tue and Thursday)

St Mary's Oratory	11.00am (Wednesday only)
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Saturday

St Columb's Church	10.00am & 7.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)
Church of Immaculate Conception	6.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	6.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)

Confessions

St Columb's Church	Monday – Friday 7.00pm – 7.25pm Saturday after 10.00 Mass
Church of Immaculate Conception	Saturday 5.30pm – 5.55pm
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	Saturday 5.30pm – 5.55pm

Parish Office 32 Chapel Road, Derry BT47 2BB. Tel. 02871 342303

Email: secretary@watersideparish.net **Web:** www.watersideparish.net

YouTube Channel: www.youtube.com/WatersideParish

Rev. Michael Canny PP 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net

Rev. Patrick Lagan CC 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net

Rev Joshy Parokkaran CC 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net

SAFEGUARDING CHILDREN AND VULNERABLE ADULTS – If you are concerned about the welfare and safety of children or a vulnerable adult contact: Designated Diocesan Person Ms Marie Gormley at 07596500793 or marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org or PSNI 101.

Our Churches are monitored by CCTV cameras and by live streaming. Live streaming can be viewed online at the parish website. The Diocese of Derry Privacy Notice is displayed on the parish website and Church notice board.

Missing & Online-Only Bulletins

Generated 16/08/2026

The following parishes do not have a downloadable PDF bulletin. Click a link to view the bulletin online.

Ballinascreen (& Desertmartin amalgamated):

https://www.parishofballinascreen.com/ballinascreen-desertmartin-parishes-16_august_2026

Banagher: <https://www.banagherparish.com/information#47-9-newsletters>

Claudy: [http://parishofclaudy.com/onewebmedia/NEWSLETTER 16-8-26.docx](http://parishofclaudy.com/onewebmedia/NEWSLETTER_16-8-26.docx)

Clonleigh (Strabane Pastoral Area): <https://clonleighparish.com/category/newsletter/>

Coleraine (St John): <https://www.parishofstjohncoleraine.com/>

Desertmartin: https://www.desertmartinparish.com/?page_id=6

Errigal: <https://www.errigalparish.com/news.html>

Greencastle: <https://greencastleparish.com/>

Iskaheen: <https://i0.wp.com/www.iskaheenparish.com/wp-content/uploads/2026/04/1.jpg?w=1090&ssl=1>

Limavady: <https://www.limavadyparish.org/onewebmedia/16-8-26.pdf>

Long Tower: <https://longtowerchurch.org/>

Malin: <https://malinparish.ie/wp-content/uploads/2026/08/Bulletin-16th-August-2026.pdf>

Urney and Castlefin: http://urneyandcastlefinparish.com/?page_id=1227